

George Douglas Papers annotated transcription

Volume III

Folder 2 Correspondence and legal papers

Version 1.0

September 2026

Prepared for Volney Douglas
For contribution to Abilene Christian University
Special Collections and Archives

Direct transcription with marked uncertainties and editorial notes. Original scans supplied by ACU; AI-assisted typescript offered for repository review.

This volume covers 158 source scan pages. The complete set covers six PDFs and 387 scan pages. Damaged passages remain partial or tentative where marked.

Volumes in this edition

- I Guide and finding aid with sermon and church papers
- II Folder 1 Correspondence and loan papers
- III Folder 2 Correspondence and legal papers
- IV Folder 3 Correspondence and legal papers

Reading this volume

Preparation and review

Prepared for Volney Douglas with AI assistance in September 2026, from visual reading of the supplied scans. Each scan received an initial reading; selected doubtful passages received a focused second reading. The page inventory identifies the review level. This edition has not received an independent human transcription check or repository approval. It is offered for scholarly review and correction, and does not replace the source images.

Wording and layout

Original wording, spelling, grammar, abbreviations and recoverable punctuation are retained. No silent expansion or modernization is intended. Handwritten capitalization, punctuation and word division sometimes require judgment. Superscripts are lowered to the baseline. Ordinary line wrapping is reflowed; verse lines, addresses and separate text blocks are distinguished. Underlining and decorative features are not systematically encoded. This is a direct reading transcript, not a facsimile or a fully diplomatic edition.

Uncertainty notation

Double square brackets contain editorial intervention. `[[illegible]]` means writing could not be read; an unspecified gap does not imply a word count. Adjacent unreadable spans may be combined. A stated extent, such as `[[illegible: approximately 3 words]]`, is an estimate. `[[word?]]` gives a tentative reading, including tentative phrases. `[[lost: torn edge]]` records writing missing at a damaged edge; `[[obscured: fold]]` identifies an obstruction. Original single brackets remain as written. No missing wording is supplied solely to produce a fluent sentence.

Corrections and separate blocks

`[[deleted: text]]` records readable canceled text; `[[deleted: illegible]]` records an unread cancellation. `[[inserted: text]]` records a significant insertion in its intended position. `[[margin]]` and `[/margin]]` enclose marginal writing. `[[postmark]]` and `[[postage]]` identify postal text. `[[blank]]`, `[[seal]]` and `[[sketch]]` identify useful non-textual features. A `[[separate block: description]]` marker introduces an independently positioned passage. Handwriting or cancellation may itself be uncertain.

Source order and later descriptions

Entries follow the PDFs' scan order. Where the leaves appear out of sequence, the editorial note suggests a reading order without moving the entry. Later identifying slips are transcribed separately; their names, dates and attributions are not silently substituted for manuscript readings. Duplicate scans retain separate entries. Apparent contradictions are recorded rather than reconciled.

References and corrections

A page ID such as 05-025 means source 05, PDF scan page 25, counting the cover as page 1. A block ID such as 05-025-P02 adds the second transcript paragraph or block. These are editorial locators; they are not manuscript page numbers. Suggested citation: George Douglas Papers annotated transcription,

version 1.0, 05-025-P02; corresponding source 05, scan page 25. For a correction, give that locator, the existing wording, a proposed reading, and the image or other evidence supporting it.

Repository credit

Original documents and scans: George Douglas Papers, 1830–1939, Center for Restoration Studies MS 5, Abilene Christian University Special Collections and Archives, Brown Library, Abilene Christian University, Abilene, Texas. Collection address printed in the supplied files:

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Source 05

ACU CRS MS5 - 05 - Folder 2, Correspondence and Legal Papers.pdf

158 PDF scan pages including the repository cover.

SHA-256: 84e92f46ff5208da786ecda5bb9b497766d054a596b8383e760626a975286cbf

Scan 001 05-001

Repository cover | Source 05, PDF page 1

05-001-P01 Abilene Christian University
Digital Commons @ ACU

05-001-P02 George Douglas Papers
Digitized Manuscripts, Personal Papers and Archival Records

05-001-P03 1854

05-001-P04 George Douglas Papers Folder 2 - Correspondence and Legal Papers

05-001-P05 Douglas

05-001-P06 Follow this and additional works at: https://digitalcommons.acu.edu/george_douglas
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Scan 002 05-002

Identifying slip | Source 05, PDF page 2

05-002-P01 To N. L. Douglas
from Henry Douglas
Palestine, Tex.
Jan. 12, 1855

Scan 003 05-003

Manuscript | Source 05, PDF page 3

05-003-P01 Palestine Tex. Jan. 12 1855

Dear Father:

I have been looking for a letter from home; for a long time, not having heard from any of you since I left there in Oct. But as I have not heard I *[[illegible]]* to write again *[[illegible]]* I think it rather uncertain *[[illegible]]* you would hear from me

Lest you might have failed to get any of my late letters, I would say that I have written several times since November, & this must excuse me if such be the case

I much desired a letter from you before making arrangements for the present year, & I waited until New Years day for that purpose. Being then left entirely on my own judgement I concluded to remain here one year longer, & risk the consequences. Dr Kendrick & myself have formed a partnership for the year. I get ⅓ of the accounts, & am at ⅓ the expence, pay my board & furnish my own horse

The advantages of this arrangement are, — his experience — a share in a practice which is firmly

established — and a division of responsibility in bad cases, which is not the least of things to be considered. The disadvantages are,

Editorial note. Abrasion or fading at the folds interrupts the opening paragraph. The shares are read as one-third; the second is faint.

Scan 004 05-004

Manuscript | Source 05, PDF page 4

05-004-P01 — a probability of making more money elsewhere — the greater incentive to study, by being thrown on my own resources — & it may be the loss of a good field of operations by being 1 year later. — Have I done wisely, or not?

We have great opposition here both from *[[numbers?]]* & prej*[[illegible]]* This latter is, however giving *[[illegible]]* in the minds of the people; & as for the Doctors, it makes but little difference what they think, say, or do. Dr K's practice has been regularly on the increase, for some time, & will continue to do so. Old Mr Ransom, (whom I take to be a man of strong prejudices) has declared his intention to try Dr K when next he wants a physician. Others, the same. I mention him, as he is known to you

I wrote to Warren, of a Cancer case we have on hand, which was considered doubtful, & is probably so yet, but it is now doing well & we have more hope. It was a great risk, but will be a great triumph, if a cure is effected. — My health is good. I think I can venture to promise you a visit in the Spring, say April. I could come sooner, but the winter winds & sleets are too bad. If you have not written please do so immediately. My love to all

Yours in all affection Henry Douglas

N. L. Douglas

Editorial note. Two faded phrases near the top remain unresolved. Medical claims are transcribed as the writer's historical statements.

Scan 005 05-005

Identifying slip | Source 05, PDF page 5

05-005-P01 To Mrs. Mary Douglas

from

Henry Douglas

Palestine, Texas

April 8, 1853

Scan 006 05-006

Manuscript | Source 05, PDF page 6

05-006-P01 Palestine Tex. Ap. 8, 1853

Dear Mother:

The letter from yourself & Susannah, came by last mail, & lest you be somewhat disappointed by my delay in my promised visit, I now drop you a line

I recd a letter from Uncle Sam a short time ago, suggesting the 1st of May, as the most suitable time for me to come up, in consequence of his engagements, at court in April & also Jepie's & Warrens absences, he, thinking it probable that they would not be at home until about that time. As it was of no material

difference to me, I wrote him immediately that I would be up the last week in April. & lest the letter should miscarry, I write this. Your letter was nearly 3 weeks on the way & if this makes no better speed, & nothing should hinder, I will be with you soon after you get it. I am pleased that Susannah has consented to come down with me, & hope there will be no disappointment, in any way; but that the step shall prove entirely satisfactory to all concerned. I think you are disposed to praise my humble self entirely too highly in this matter; for I have only done, what seemed to me, a reasonable duty. I feel that I have been blessed beyond my expectations, in whatsoever

Scan 007 05-007

Manuscript | Source 05, PDF page 7

05-007-P01 I have laid my hand to, since I left your roof to seek my fortune in the wide world. I know that while memory lasts I shall never forget the day when I parted from Father, in the wide lonely prairie, near the Willow pond, his parting advice, & the loneliness of the subsequent hours in walking to Porters Bluff. Never till then had I felt so isolated; never had I felt what it was to be homeless, houseless, & in effect, friendless, for I was going amongst strangers, & I knew not whither I took everything upon trust; & have not been disappointed. I have been blest with health & plenty; not so abundantly as some, but as much as I had any right to hope for. I repeat then, that I deserve no praise, but if I can render any service to others I am only doing my duty.

You may, then, expect me up about the last of April, (of course I can't say precisely) & I hope to remain with you a week or 10 days, maybe longer. The weather has been very dry with us, for a long time, & crops are suffering greatly for rain. Corn has been badly frostbitten & much of it will be to plant again. I fear the wheat has been ruined, with you. I remain as ever, your affectionate Son,
Henry Douglas.

Mrs Mary Douglas

05-007-P02 *[[margin]]* P.S. Give my love to all. Remember me to *[[Un.??]]* & aunt Cynthia. &c &c
H.D. *[[/margin]]*

Editorial note. The postscript is inverted at the top of the image. The abbreviation before "& aunt Cynthia" is uncertain.

Scan 008 05-008

Identifying slip | Source 05, PDF page 8

05-008-P01 To N. L. Douglas
from
Henry Douglas
Mississippi County,
Missouri
June 23, 1860
— re driving herd of
sheep to Texas

Scan 009 05-009

Manuscript | Source 05, PDF page 9

05-009-P01 Missisipi County, Missouri

June 23d 1860

Dear Father:

After a long lapse of time I now find an opportunity to write you. I have nothing encouraging to write. I have had to pay from 1 to 2 dollars for sheep & have been at a great deal of trouble to find them & expense in collecting my drove. Mr Willis Helm sent \$500 by me to get him some sheep & with the 1500 I have bought 750 head & do not know that I will have money enough to get them to Tex. as I only have some 200 left. I bought common sheep in Callaway & Graves Co's Ky purchase lambs at 1 & Ewes at 1.25 per head but could not get enough & so went back to Christian Co & got some 250 head at 1.75 & 2 per head These are finer sheep & I would now prefer that all my funds were invested in such sheep I crossed the Mississippi at the Iron Banks last Sunday & had to pay 8 cts per head ferriage then after driving two days I had to stop on account of the sheep taking a disease from poison or some thing else. Several have died & altogether I have lost near 50 head since I started, mostly however by their dodging in the thickets the first few days

Scan 010 05-010

Manuscript | Source 05, PDF page 10

05-010-P01 driving. I learn that every drove of sheep that has passed through here has suffered severely in the same way that mine has. Last year about this time a Mr Long passed through with 1000 & lost 150 to 200. A Mr South, Methodist preacher, with 3 or 400 lost only a few. He passed through about the last of July. A few days ago a drove of 7 or 800 passed from Rutherford Co Tennessee & lost a great many. The people here say that I have escaped better than any of them & they say, further, that after leaving here all the droves did well which I greatly hope is true. I now have my sheep in a large crabgrass pasture free of charge, & will remain till I think it prudent to start which I hope will be in 3 or 4 days. Nearly all are doing finely but probably 50 show a diseased condition. The symptoms are, first a drooping & swelling of the ears, which thicken up the cellular tissue being filled with yellow serum. The sheep becomes dull & stupid & in some cases the head swells — under the jaw the skin will hang in a pouch & I have stuck my knife into several & the yellow serum would flow freely. I know that I have lost 5 since I crossed the river & one more will die, probably. I forget to say that, after the head swells the sheep suffers from an intolerable itching, judging from its actions, & the hair will come off when the swelling goes. I have 2 toll gates

Scan 011 05-011

Manuscript | Source 05, PDF page 11

05-011-P01 to pass before I get clear of the swamps & then no more I suppose till I get to Fort Gibson ferry on the Arkansas. I have 4 hands hired at 15 dollars per month each & taking all together I cannot make the drove profitable if I do not lose by it. I have not heard from any of you since I left Texas nor have I heard from Ellen since I left Lincoln County. Taking everything into consideration I cannot feel otherwise than "low down" but win or lose I am bound to go through. My health is still good & if I dont get sick I think I can stand it. Now I have written this I do not know that it would be best to send it, but you had

better know the truth than to be in suspense. I suppose I will reach Springfield Mo. in 30 or 40 days & you must write me at that place & also at Fort Gibson, & write to Warren to do the same as I am very anxious to hear from all of you. I have been much disappointed & perplexed by men who engaged with me for the trip, failing to come up at the appointed time & some not coming at all. This required me to hire hands temporarily & higher prices & to pay them off when they quit, which has been a heavy draw on my pocket. I will write again — for the present this is enough. Love to all.

Your affectionate son. H. Douglas

Scan 012 05-012

Note and identifying slip | Source 05, PDF page 12

05-012-P01 *[[separate block: identifying slip]]*

(Promisory) Note to N. L.

Douglas. By

Samuel Wallace

Oct. 2, 1832

05-012-P02 *[[separate block: manuscript note]]*

By the 25th December next I promise to pay to N L Douglas at his house five barrels corn, or four Dollars, value recd this 2nd Oct. 1832.

Samuel Wallace *[[seal]]*

Scan 013 05-013

Identifying slip | Source 05, PDF page 13

05-013-P01 To L. N. Douglas

Business Letter

from

James Bass

Murfreesboro,

Tenn.

April 18, 1854

Editorial note. The initials on this identifying slip are L. N.; they are not silently reordered.

Scan 014 05-014

Manuscript | Source 05, PDF page 14

05-014-P01 Murfreesboro Ten

April 18 /54.

My Dear Sir

It has been about two years since I heard from you in relation to our business — it has been I believe nearly three years. I should be glad to have a letter from you — giving me full accounts of every thing, and I hope you will write to me immediately on the receipt of this.

I have bought lately of Gen. A. Sublett the balance of the Littleton White tract of Land — the purchase embraces about thirty two hundred & fifty acres — You know where it is situated & I want you to see to it. See whether the Taxes are paid, and give me any information you may be able to obtain in relation to

it.

I would be obliged to you to write me fully about the Louis Dickson tract of Land on the Trinity River (I believe it is called the Louis Dickson tract) — Gen. A. Sublett owns it & I am thinking about buying it. I believe the Land is at the mouth of the five mile *[[deleted: branch?]]* *[[inserted: creek]]*

Write me what the Land is worth & give me any information you may have, or can get, in relation to it.

Editorial note. The deleted word after “five mile” is read tentatively as “branch”; “creek” is inserted above it.

Scan 015 05-015

Manuscript | Source 05, PDF page 15

05-015-P01 I expect to be in Texas in the fall & will see you

I am your friend & obt, servt,

James Bass

05-015-P02 Nathaniel Douglas

Red Oak Post Office

Texas.

05-015-P03 *[[separate block: faint lower marks]]*

[[illegible]]

3

Editorial note. The faint lower panel appears to contain postal or offset marks; no reliable extended wording can be recovered.

Scan 016 05-016

Identifying slip | Source 05, PDF page 16

05-016-P01 Oct. 12, 1852

Note of promise

to pay G. A. Sublett,

\$520.00 by

S. A. Farrar

F. L. Farrar

05-016-P02 Apr. 20, 1853

\$15.00 received on

note by N. L. Douglas

for G. A. Sublett

Editorial note. The superscript cents are rendered after a decimal point. The amount is fifteen dollars, consistent with the receipt on scan page 18.

Scan 017 05-017

Promissory note | Source 05, PDF page 17

05-017-P01 On or before the first day of March next I promise G. A. Sublett to pay him or order Five Hundred and twenty Dollars value received witness my and Seal This the 12th day of October 1852

[[S. A. ?]] Farrar

F. L. Farrar

Editorial note. The first signature's initials are difficult. The words "witness my and Seal" are transcribed without silently supplying "hand." Faint reversed writing appears to be show-through.

Scan 018 05-018

Note endorsements | Source 05, PDF page 18

05-018-P01 April 20th 1853

Received on the within Note Fifteen dollars. N L Douglas
for G. A. Sublett,

05-018-P02 Farrar's Note to Sublett

05-018-P03 Pay the within to Mr [[Ledbetter?]] [[deleted: illegible]]

1852 oct 28th

Geo A Sublett

Editorial note. The receipt reads "Fifteen dollars." The payee in the endorsement is tentative; canceled and overwritten text is partly unreadable.

Scan 019 05-019

Identifying slip | Source 05, PDF page 19

05-019-P01 Redemption of land

for taxes pd. by

G. A. Sublett

N. L. Douglas

(acting as attorney)

to tax collector &

assessor, Navarro Co.

W. B. McCabe

Jan 23, 1851

Scan 020 05-020

Docket | Source 05, PDF page 20

05-020-P01 Rit of Revocation

of

A J Porter 1280 acres

Land Taxes & cost

paid up to 1850

05-020-P02 Tax and cost \$14.48

Editorial note. "Rit of Revocation" is retained as written; the heading is not modernized to a legal term.

Scan 021 05-021

Land tax instrument | Source 05, PDF page 21

05-021-P01 State of Texas

County of Navarro

This is to certify that N L Douglas as agent for G A Sublett has this day *[[deleted: paid]]* paid me the amount of Tax and Cost of Sale and one hundred per cent there and as required by Law for the Redemption of 1280 acres of Land lying on Subletts Creek and sold by me for the Taxes for the year 1848 *[[inserted: and listed to A J Porter]]* on the fourth day of February AD 1850 and purchased by C M Winkler for the Taxes and cost and also the Taxes on the Same Land for the year 1849 in consideration where of Said payment and the power invested in me by an act of the Legislature past and approved the 11th February 1850 Do hereby Revoke and Release the above Land to the Riteful owners or owners of *[[illegible]]* heirs *[[illegible]]* and *[[illegible]]* Given under my hand and Seal. using a Scroll in way of Seal this 23d day of January 1851

W. B. McCabe *[[seal]]*

assessor & collector

for the county Navarro

05-021-P02 I ratify and sanction the doings of W. B. McCabe assessor & collector for Navarro County in relation to 1280 acres of land surveyed in the name of A. J. Porter and hereby release all claim to said land — Jany 31st 1851

C M Winkler

Editorial note. Several words in the release clause are unclear. The final day is read as 31st; the first written day is 23d.

Scan 022 05-022

Due bill and identifying slip | Source 05, PDF page 22

05-022-P01 *[[separate block: identifying slip]]*

L. W. Webber due

bill to N. L. Douglas

Jan. 21, 1829

05-022-P02 *[[separate block: manuscript]]*

Due N. L. Douglas or bearer five dollars value received. January. 21st 1829.

[[S W?]] Webber

Editorial note. The first signature initial resembles S; the later identifying slip gives L. W. Both are preserved separately.

Scan 023 05-023

Identifying slip | Source 05, PDF page 23

05-023-P01 Geo. A. Sublett

Rutherford Co., Tenn.

Conveys to

N. L. Douglas

power of attorney —

to sell tracks of
land in Dallas,
Ellis & Navarro Co.,
Texas
including sale to
Mr Farro &
Ephraim Andrews
Oct 28, 1852

Scan 024 05-024

Docket | Source 05, PDF page 24

05-024-P01 Geo A Sublett
To N L Douglas
Power of attorney

05-024-P02 Filed Oct 29th 1852 at
2½ Oclock P.M.
By *[[A?]]* Hawkins Clk
C.C.E.C.

05-024-P03 fee \$0.90 paid

Editorial note. The clerk's given-name initial is tentative.

Scan 025 05-025

Power of attorney | Source 05, PDF page 25

05-025-P01 State of Texas
Ellis County

To all who shall see these presents: Greeting —

Know ye, that for divers good causes and considerations I Geo A Sublett of the County of Rutherford and State of Tennessee have nominated and appointed, made and constituted my friend N L Douglas of Ellis County State of Texas, my true and lawful attorney for me, and in my name to bargain Sell Grant and convey, with or without General warranty, any part or all of the lands that, I own in the State of Texas — in the Counties of Dallas, Ellis, and Navaro, in one or more *[[deleted: tracts]]* *[[inserted: tracts]]* as he my think proper. likewise to make proper conveyance to Mr. Farro for a tract of Six hundred and forty acres heretofore Sold him, also to Ephraim Andrews & Co. Five hundred and Forty acres in two Seperate Surveys. Also he is authorized to change the lines of Six hundred & Forty acre Survey heretofore Sold to him. Giving and Granting to my Said attorney full and ample authority to Sell and collect any debts due me at any time in as full and ample manner as I would possess, hereby ratifying and confirming whatever my Said attorney Shall lawfully do in and about the premises. Witness my hand and Seal, *[[inserted: the same being a scroll]]* this 28th October — 1852 —
Geo A Sublett *[[seal]]*

Scan 026 05-026

Acknowledgment and recording | Source 05, PDF page 26

05-026-P01 State of Texas

County of Ellis

This day personally appeared before me Benj F Hawkins Clerk of the County Court of Ellis County, the within named Geo A Sublett with whom I am well acquainted, and whose signature appears to the foregoing power of attorney, and acknowledged that he signed sealed and Delivered the same as his act and deed for the purposes therein Contained.

In witness whereof I have hereunto set my hand and official seal this 29th day of October AD 1852
Benj. F. Hawkins Clk C.C.E.C.

05-026-P02 I Benj F Hawkins Clerk of the County Court of Ellis County State of Texas do hereby Certify that the within power of attorney was duly duly Recorded November 8th A.D. 1852 at 9 O'clock A.M. in Deed Record A page 163.

Witness my hand and official seal this 8th day of November AD 1852
Benj F. Hawkins Clk C.C.E.C.

Editorial note. "duly duly" is retained. The identification here supports F. Hawkins, but no earlier initials are silently expanded.

Scan 027 05-027

Typed verse | Source 05, PDF page 27

05-027-P01 There is a loneliness of heart

No words can ere express,
Too deep for sorrow's tears to start
To relieve the aching breast.
A sunrless, motionless, waveless
waste,
All dark and drearily forelorn
And every lovely flower that
placed upon it, hides a poisonous
thorn.

05-027-P02 1867 G. Douglas

Editorial note. This is a typescript, not handwriting. "lonliness," "sunrless," and "forelorn" are retained as printed; lines follow the typescript.

Scan 028 05-028

Identifying slip | Source 05, PDF page 28

05-028-P01 Sold by

Robert Crow
to G. A. Sublett
1280 acres land
Leon Co. May 19,
1849

(N. L. Douglas
acting as
attorney)

Scan 029 05-029

Land conveyance | Source 05, PDF page 29

05-029-P01 The State of Texas

County of Leon

Be it known that on this the 19th day of May AD 1849 I Robert Crow for and in consideration of the sum of one hundred and Sixty dollars to me in hand paid by G A Sublett the receipt whereof is hereby acknowledged have granted bargained and sold and by these presents do grant bargain sell and convey in fee all that tract lot or parcel of land containing twelve hundred and Eighty acres being the same secured to me the said Crow by virtue of a certificate issued by the board of land commissioners for Jasper County on the tenth day of January AD 1840 — 2d Class No 246 To have and to hold said bargained land together with the certificate securing the same: To the said Sublett his heirs or assigns. And I the said Robert Crow for myself my heirs and assigns shall and will warrant and defend said bargained land and certificate to the said Sublett his heirs and assigns. And I hereby authorize the Commissioner of the General Land office to issue the Patent for the same in the name of G. A. Sublett as my assignee Given under

Scan 030 05-030

Acknowledgment | Source 05, PDF page 30

05-030-P01 my hand and seal on this the above day and date

Witness

Robt Crow *[[seal]]*

05-030-P02 The State of Texas

County of Leon

Before me David M. Brown Chief Justice and Exofficio Notary public in and for the county and State aforesaid came and appeared Robert Crow whose name appears to the foregoing instrument and acknowledged the same to be his act and deed for the purposes and considerations therein expressed In testimony whereof I hereto set my hand and official Seal of office on the 22d day of may AD 1849
D. M. Brown

Chief Justice &

Ex off Notary Public

Editorial note. Heavy reversed show-through has not been treated as additional writing on this side.

Scan 031 05-031

Manuscript | Source 05, PDF page 31

05-031-P01 R Crow

05-031-P02 Filed for Record at 9 Oclock A.M. Augt the 8th A.D. 1849

R *[[H?]]* White C.C.C.N.C.

Recorded the 14th day of December A.D. 1849 in Book A, pages 433 & 34
R *[[H?]]* White Clk Navarro Co

05-031-P03 Riggs
Fee \$1.00

Editorial note. Docket rotated for reading. The clerk's middle initial is uncertain.

Scan 032 05-032

Identifying slip | Source 05, PDF page 32

05-032-P01 Revocation for
Robert Crow
redemption of
land grant for
taxes
N. L. Douglas,
[[agent?]] for
G A Sublett
Feb 1, 1851

Scan 033 05-033

Manuscript | Source 05, PDF page 33

05-033-P01 State of Texas
County of Navarro

05-033-P02 Know all men by these presents that N L Douglas as agent for G A Sublett has this day paid to me the undersigned assessor & Collector for the county and State aforesaid the following Sum Required by Law for the Redemption of 640 acres of Land granted to Robert Crow and Given in by G A Sublett for Taxes for the year 1849 and Sold by me for the Taxes for the year 1849 on the 25th day of July AD 1850 and bid off to the State for the Tax and Interest and cost of Sale. amounting to the following Sums To Witt

05-033-P03 Tax for the year 1849 State Tax 50 county 25 Total | 75
interest at 8 percent for *[[deleted: Six]]* ten Months | 8
cost of Sale Deed and advertising | 1.00
and this Ritt | 75
[[inserted: Tax for the year 1850]] | 50
Total amount of all | *[[deleted: \$2.58]]* \$3.08

05-033-P04 In consideration of the above Sums I W B McCabe assessor & Collector for the county of Navarro doo hear by by the power Con*[[lost: scan edge]]*ted in me by an act approved the 11th February 1850 Revoke and Releas said Land to the former owner or owners

05-033-P05 Given under my hand and Seal using Scroll in way of Seal this 3d day of February AD 1851
W B McCabe *[[seal]]*
assessor & Collector for Navarro County

Editorial note. The date on the instrument is 3 February 1851, differing from the preceding label. Some right-hand line ends meet the scan boundary; the incomplete word before “in me” is not reconstructed.

Scan 034 05-034

Manuscript | Source 05, PDF page 34

05-034-P01 *[[separate block: docket]]*

Revocation for Robert Crow

640 *[[illegible]]*

05-034-P02 Filed for Record at 2 Oclock P.M. Febr. 3rd A.D. 1851

R *[[H?]]* White C.C.C.N.C.

Recorded at ½ past 2 Oclock P.M. Febr. 3rd A.D. 1851 in Book C, page 181

R *[[H?]]* White Clk Navarro Co

Fee \$1.25

05-034-P03 *[[separate block: acknowledgment]]*

The State of Texas

County of Navarro

05-034-P04 Personally appeared before me R *[[H?]]* White Clerk of the County Court W. B. McCabe Assessor & Collector for Navarro County, whose signature appears to to foregoing instrument of writing to me well Known and acknowledged that he signed sealed and delivered the same for the purposes and consideration therein stated

05-034-P05 In Testimony Whereof I have hereunto set my hand and Seal of office at Corsicana this 3rd day of Febr 1851

R *[[H?]]* White C.C.C.N.C.

Editorial note. The docket runs at right angles to the acknowledgment. “to to” is retained as written. The clerk’s middle initial is uncertain.

Scan 035 05-035

Label and envelope | Source 05, PDF page 35

05-035-P01 *[[separate block: later label]]*

To Miss Lizzie Douglas

from Niece

Sarah Gail (Douglas) Headrick

Bardsdale, Calif

[[Sat?]] 29, 1893

05-035-P02 *[[separate block: envelope]]*

from Sadie

Miss Lizzie Douglas

Ferris

Ellis Co.

Texas

05-035-P03 *[[postmark]]* BARDSDALE AUG 9 *[[1894?]]* CAL. *[[/postmark]]*

Editorial note. The later label, the envelope postmark, and the date of the following letter are transcribed independently; their apparent dates do not all agree.

Scan 036 05-036

Manuscript | Source 05, PDF page 36

05-036-P01 Bardsdale, Sep, 29th, 1893.

05-036-P02 My Dear Aunt:—I finished up my morning work pretty well this forenoon, so now I will take time to write to you. I am still better—haven't had a "break down" since I wrote last.

05-036-P03 I have every room swept nicely—I still have a bed in my sitting-room two rockers, two footstools, nicely covered, the stand-table, Mr. *[[Curren?]]* made, two tea-baskets on the mantle-piece, my vases, & two advertisement pictures, which makes the room presentable.

05-036-P04 I try to keep the door opening in to the hall closed, so as to have the room ready to receive anyone; for they come, at any and all hours, being as Bruce

05-036-P05 *[[margin]]* This afternoon I made 4 glasses of preserves out of the last quart of my black berries—I haven't much fruit left. Wont I have a sieve filling my jars by and By. *[[/margin]]*

Editorial note. The top-margin addition is inverted in the scan and is transcribed after the main text.

Scan 037 05-037

Manuscript | Source 05, PDF page 37

05-037-P01 says "togezzer" (together) with the store. One day he came from the P.O. & said "Grandma *[[Chadens?]]* house isn't togezzer is it Mamma?" "Ours is though" He noticed that her Post Office doesn't join her dwelling, while our store does—dont you think him quite observant? Mr. Headrick has been down with his back, for two weeks, till he could scarcely move, but is much better now—last week he wasn't able to help me work, at all, so I did it (a small washing) alone as you know I am better, I sat & rinsed them in a bucket. Used all the rain water, so I didn't get it done this week. Mrs. *[[Scholl?]]* started back to Kansas the 19th. Her son & children went with her. She said *[[illegible]]*

Editorial note. The last line is faint and cut by the lower scan boundary. The quoted child's pronunciation is retained.

Scan 038 05-038

Manuscript | Source 05, PDF page 38

05-038-P01 I dreamed, last night of being at the old homestead, & telling you & Grandma my troubles, as I was wont to do in by-gone days & also of seeing Uncle *[[George?]]* Strange I didn't dream of any of the rest. A few nights before I dreamed of Grandma. You know I often have that pleasure I suppose, because I often think & speak of her. Since I began writing Elmo brought me your letter from the Office. Your dresses are indeed lovely—You are carrying out my advice, "Get plenty of nice clothes" better than I expected—I am glad of it, and know you will enjoy wearing them this summer

Editorial note. A dark blot obscures parts of several right-hand line ends. The uncle's name is tentative.

Scan 039 05-039

Manuscript | Source 05, PDF page 39

05-039-P01 I got the children broad brimmed cloth hats for every day, and they have nails side by side to hang them on, and Elmo will not let Bruce use his nail *[[for?]]* anything. You ought to see *[[him?]]* trudging in with kindling—whenever, & wherever he finds it, he picks it up as eagerly as I would & brings it in—Last sunday they were sitting in a window, and along came Mr. *[[McKie's?]]* cow—Elmo remarked if that cow was married, she would have a calf. (with her he meant) Making that a *[[test?]]* most of the California cows are unmarried.

Editorial note. Blotting affects the upper right-hand text. The final “test” reading is uncertain.

Scan 040 05-040

Manuscript | Source 05, PDF page 40

05-040-P01 There is a thought contained in the piece headed “A *[[Lyffe?]]*” (in Advocate of April 13th) by D. L. which had never entered my mind & which would be profitably impressed on the mind of every mother, & that is that we are “teaching our children what is in our own hearts whether we try or not”. I paused, in my busy life, & asked what am I teaching mine? I have given three mothers the benefit of the thought. I am surprised that *[[Curren?]]* has another *[[boy?]]*. Saw in my last paper, the announcement, by Uncle Geo. of the *[[Elmwood?]]* camp-meeting—How I wish I could attend as of old. Remember me to Bro. Polly & tell him I still enjoy, in retrospection the meetings he held, for us, before he was

Editorial note. The article title, surname, and meeting place are uncertain; blotting affects the passage about another child.

Scan 041 05-041

Manuscript | Source 05, PDF page 41

05-041-P01 I think part of his laughter, was because he was so glad to see you. Mr. H. and I think them, not at all, natural; but they are fine work—what a pity the expression isn’t good—I never look at them with any satisfaction; but always get the good picture I have of you, to counteract the wrong impression. Last week Mr. H. went to Los Angeles—Kate *[[Larson?]]* staid with me, Bruce was sick with cold & fever & derangement of bowels—so we had quite a time—While we were eating supper in came over 20 doz. eggs to be counted, I ran & got the other lamp & told Kate to light

Editorial note. The opening does not continue the preceding scanned page’s final sentence; source scan order is retained.

Scan 042 05-042

Manuscript | Source 05, PDF page 42

05-042-P01 & she & the children to proceed with their supper; but bless you when I returned I found them in the dark & Kate’s coffee cold. The children had turned the wick out of the lamp, through the day (something they have never done before) I had to chop kindling & heat the coffee & by the time we finished, eat, washed the dishes, put the children to bed, made up light-bread, I was pretty tired & besides that I had had fever since the middle of the afternoon. Then I had Elmo to take up twice in the night. The

next morning I worked my bread down, & started breakfast; but Bruce waked & had to be dressed & taken out 3 or 4 times before I got

Scan 043 05-043

Manuscript | Source 05, PDF page 43

05-043-P01 it eaten—While we were eating in came a Life Insurance Agent & tried to get me to influence Mr. H. to insure. I told him 'twas against my religious convictions He said “christianity would never keep you from starving to death besides the majority of christians favored it” I told him the “majority” were on their way to perdition too. He hammered away, & there was Bruce by me with his drawers messed & calling for help; finally I was so provoked, I told him to go to Mr. H. his convictions were somewhat different from mine & if he could convince him

Scan 044 05-044

Manuscript | Source 05, PDF page 44

05-044-P01 you her kindest regards, & you dont know how glad she was to get out of these mountains; but I just guess you do, as you were just as glad. One day Elmo came in & said, “I wouldn’t live in Mrs. H. *[[Chadens?]]* house, would you, Mamma, with a barn pieced on?” He also said he thought the cause of his stomach hurting him lately was, that his Papa didn’t clean him good one day when I was away”—Now you & Ellen shake your sides.

05-044-P02 Last monday week, I went up to Mrs. Timmons & found her abed with nervous prostration—her back was something like Mr. H’s.

Editorial note. The opening appears to continue a different leaf from the preceding scan. Source order is retained; the surname is uncertain.

Scan 045 05-045

Manuscript | Source 05, PDF page 45

05-045-P01 At times, she is almost blind & deaf—all I think from nervousness, caused from weakness. One day, the men were away, & one of their young mares, got in the wire & she chopped it out, & saved its life—that was the one thing I think that laid her up—poor woman! she cries & cries because she can’t keep that house just as she did—her milk is dried entirely, so she is raising the babe on a bottle; but it is doing all right.

05-045-P02 I gave her the pictures you sent & they all think it good and are glad to get it; but oh! you ought to have seen Elmo, when he looked at them—he shrugged his shoulders & laughed & laughed & said, Don’t she look funny?

Scan 046 05-046

Later label | Source 05, PDF page 46

05-046-P01 To Miss Lizzie Douglas
(aunt)
from
(Sarah) Sadie Gail

Douglas Headrick

Bardsdale

Aug. 8

[[illegible: faint fragment below label]]

Scan 047 05-047

Manuscript | Source 05, PDF page 47

05-047-P01 Bardsdale August 8th. Dearest Aunt:—I have just gotten dinner over. Mr. Headrick has gone to work, Elmo is seated on the table, and Bruce by it with a slate, and talking more. I am as well as usual. Mr. H. helped me wash yesterday. Grandma Humphrey's growth increases, and is so bad she has difficulty in breathing—consequently has consented to have an operation performed; which, I greatly fear she will not undergo. Dr. *[[Hinckley?]]* is back now and he Drs. Bard and Mott, are to do the work. I saw Dr. H. passing, once since his return. I spoke, told him I was glad to see him back, and expressed lasting gratitude for his kindness. Could hardly keep from saying if he thought half as much of me, as I did of him, he would have called to see us sooner. but of course we can't express ourselves thus freely, to strangers.

05-047-P02 We had our picnic at Mr. Grimes, last saturday, which was quite a success. I prepared a good dinner in case I should get a chance to go; but the hour came for starting, and no opportunity presented itself. How fully I realized that if I was back there, or even you here it would be different. Had I acted on my own feelings, I would have put forth no effort to go; but the children were so anxious to go, they said, if I didn't go down and ask Mr. Wigmore for his cart, they would. I knew they couldn't bring it alone, so I went with them but fortunately for my "brazen face" it had been spoken for, and I found it out before I had to ask. I found Mrs. Pickering hardly able to be out of bed, and still fixing to go off camping, in hopes 'twould enable her to stay a little while longer with her children. So I swept her house, cooked her two jelly cakes, and came on home about noon. Mr. H. took his dinner so the children and I sat down and ate picnic dinner alone. After we had finished, and I had sat down, to read a little, down came Mr. Henry Chadsey in Mrs. *[[Curren's?]]* surrey, for us. Lillie Chadsey had inquired of several why I wasn't there, and

Editorial note. No year is supplied in this page's heading. Several personal names have uncertain letter forms.

Scan 048 05-048

Manuscript | Source 05, PDF page 48

05-048-P01 the answer of all was of course, "I guess she didn't have any way". She told them there was no reason I shouldn't have a way, when there were so many conveyances there, so she started Henry in a hurry. I was thankful on account of the children especially. They had a large table heavily loaded, with choicest food. Mrs. Grimes took up nearly all her dishes, and every one else took plenty so it was a set table just like you would have at your own home. But just such a mixture of dishes, you never heard of. It took them quite awhile to get them straightened out. They had lemonade and ice-cream. two swings a set of croquet, and a game of baseball. And *[[no part?]]* of the pleasure was due wholly to Lillie Chadsey. I was amused to observe, as she came down in the afternoon, to see Elmo running her. Imagine him handling (or rather attempting to) over Two hundred pounds. But you know he always rather liked her. That was the 4th, and little *[[Beckie's?]]* birthday, and what think you, she went to Santa Paula with Mr. *[[Reck?]]* *[[Lehock?]]* and married him unbeknowing to her father. The old gentleman is quite wrathly

over it. ordered her off the place, when she went back for her clothes, and threatened to disinherit her. It was her 18th birthday. The *[[Wilmot?]]* *[[Hagarts?]]* are not all dead yet. Grandma Roberts spent last Sunday night with us. I am always so glad to see her. I forgot to say, I heartily wished for you to dine with us, when we sat down to eat our picnic dinner all alone. Elmo said to me one day “when a girl marries a young man, she takes his name, doesn’t she”, to which I said yes, and he continued how many Headricks will there be then? Bruce was standing by, and put in, I’m going to marry a “dutch girl”. Well I must tell you that I earned \$4.50 pitting fruit. A handsome amount for me.

05-048-P02 Expecting an account of the meeting soon, I am as ever,
S. G. H.

Editorial note. The phrase before “of the pleasure” appears to read “no part”; it is marked as tentative. Personal names remain uncertain. The earnings are for pitting fruit.

Scan 049 05-049

Envelope and later label | Source 05, PDF page 49

05-049-P01 *[[separate block: envelope]]*

Mrs. Sara Headrick
Red Oak.
Texas.

05-049-P02 POSTAGE DUE 2 CENTS

[[postmark]] *[[SANTA BARBARA CAL.?]]* APR 27 6:30 PM 1921 *[[/postmark]]*

05-049-P03 *[[separate block: later label]]*

unidentified letter

– incomplete – written

– possibly by Sarah Gail (Sadie)

Douglas Headrick

Editorial note. The envelope is transcribed separately from the attribution on the later label. The postmark’s place name is incomplete.

Scan 050 05-050

Manuscript | Source 05, PDF page 50

05-050-P01 While Ellen is in bed, but she is always so soon up, it isn’t like as if you were me. I think I have heard Mrs. Weatherford speak of Cousin Sarah Jeter, and I must caution you right here, not to allow yourself to become too much infatuated with that son of hers—I thought when you got all those new dresses, ’twas not for nothing. Ill joke go free—oh yes, oh yes. Now to the news. Mr. *[[Annis?]]* has bought the Clapp ranch over the mountains. Payed \$1500. When Mr. *[[Clapp?]]* left, he sold the church organ—So Kate Burdick Wheeler & Mary Yeager, set to work to raise money to buy another. They succeeded in getting \$35 subscribed & Mr. Bard, who owns so much land here, sent a check for \$50, and

Editorial note. An incomplete letter begins mid-sentence. The quoted joke and names are not modernized.

Scan 051 05-051

Manuscript | Source 05, PDF page 51

05-051-P01 if you ever saw people smile a smile, it was last sunday, when Mr. *[[Wigart?]]* made this announcement. I had a faint hope of getting the people stirred up to investigating the scripture, last sunday week, when Mr. Pickering, our Supt and the only one in the School, who knows anything about the Bible, suggested, that we older ones get together once a week, and study by subjects—But alas, my hopes have almost departed, as no one seems to like him—I dont know why, unless it is because he knows a little. Last sunday we had a Holiness sermon from *[[illegible]]*. And such a one as it was—“Justified by faith & then away go on & on & on, before we were baptized by the Holy Ghost, which he claimed was sanctification & if I understood him aright, the crowning point of his being sanctified was quitting tobacco.

Editorial note. Page is inverted in the supplied scan. A name or phrase following “sermon from” is obscured at the fold.

Scan 052 05-052

Manuscript | Source 05, PDF page 52

05-052-P01 gotten out of it; but on she came, and instead of letting me use the pattern, I had cut, after fitting that black spencer, insisted on my using one of Kate *[[Cenesto?]]*, and put the whole responsibility on me, and after my doing my utmost, and at the same time looking after the children, keeping them out of the ditch & from running off, at the same time putting up with Marlin’s tormenting Elmo, chewing his ear, and the like racketting, & the responsibility of the store, after all these annoyances, the dress didn’t fit any where but to Mrs. *[[Timmons?]]* & Hattie were both completely outdone & seemed, to blame me, and I was surely sick—couldn’t compose my nerves, so as to sleep, for some time. If ever I devoutly thanked my Maker for quiet & rest, it was that night.

Editorial note. Page is inverted and begins mid-sentence; its opening does not continue the preceding scan. Two names remain uncertain.

Scan 053 05-053

Manuscript | Source 05, PDF page 53

05-053-P01 You dont know how I would like to have one of our preachers come in here. I was talking with Mrs. *[[Wigart?]]* on the subject of religion, & she doesn’t think water baptism, at all, essential to salvation; but still she thinks perhaps, sometime, she will be immersed—adding, she always had an idea if she ever did, the spirit would descend on her, in the shape of a dove, just as it did on Christ. Now you & Ellen, please just dont hurt yourselves laughing at the woeful disappointment, she is going to realize. Last week Mr. H. went over the mountains & worked three days. Hattie stayed with me. Mrs. *[[Timmons?]]* came down one day, with a dress for Hattie for me to cut & fit. She had tried before, to ring me into it; but I

Editorial note. This page’s final words appear to continue into scan page 52. The supplied page order is retained.

Scan 054 05-054

Later label | Source 05, PDF page 54

05-054-P01 Part of letter –

Mentions

Lizzie & Laura

from Fannie

Scan 055 05-055

Manuscript | Source 05, PDF page 55

05-055-P01 3

05-055-P02 *[[if?]]* you get sick all such trouble *[[illegible]]* they *[[illegible]]* there will always be enough left to *[[illegible]]* the *[[illegible]]* in *[[illegible]]* *[[here?]]* and a dull *[[illegible]]*

05-055-P03 Well *[[illegible]]* live without Young birds & we love only *[[memory?]]* *[[illegible]]* Haw *[[Simons?]]* and *[[illegible]]* Howard and *[[illegible]]* knowing that I wish you could be with us but you *[[illegible]]*

05-055-P04 *[[illegible]]* we will *[[inserted: and]]* we will *[[illegible]]* tell you say if you are suffring bad *[[he?]]* will not stay here and be *[[illegible]]* to *[[illegible]]* for there *[[illegible]]*

05-055-P05 I am *[[illegible]]* for we *[[illegible]]* and *[[illegible]]* at *[[illegible]]* unknown friends far away express *[[illegible]]* thoughts in *[[illegible]]* as a sister or mother *[[illegible]]*

Editorial note. The page is heavily darkened, with low contrast and interference from the reverse. Only recoverable text and tentative readings are given. The printed page number is not supplied; the manuscript has “3”. Several continuous passages require renewed examination of the original or a better scan.

Scan 056 05-056

Manuscript | Source 05, PDF page 56

05-056-P01 4

05-056-P02 Oh Lizzie I received a letter from one of the prettiest looking *[[little?]]* *[[fellows?]]* that left Johnson Co. If he is devoted *[[if?]]* I could not tell you who he is for fear you might *[[turn?]]* *[[my?]]* *[[rival?]]* he has been a school mate of mine for *[[illegible]]* I have not seen him *[[illegible]]* I should wonder if he *[[illegible]]* but *[[illegible]]*

05-056-P03 *[[illegible]]*

05-056-P04 *[[illegible]]* on Sunday *[[illegible]]* this *[[past?]]* *[[illegible]]* if it is leap year *[[illegible]]* given any of them a *[[illegible]]*

05-056-P05 But I must not keep your *[[illegible]]* longer. I shall have to close for the want of space and time. I must to write a letter to *[[Evan?]]* to night. I know he will be anxious to hear from home. Please give my love to Laura and also to *[[illegible]]* accept *[[illegible]]* *[[illegible]]* *[[Fannie?]]*

Editorial note. Manuscript page numbered 4. Severe darkening and the fold prevent a continuous reading. The signature is tentative in this image; the later identifying slip supplies Fannie separately.

Scan 057 05-057

Envelope and labels | Source 05, PDF page 57

05-057-P01 *[[separate block: envelope]]*

Miss Lizzie Douglas.

Redoak

Texas

[[postmark]] WOODBURY APR 10 TEN. *[[/postmark]]*

[[postmark]] *[[illegible]]* *[[/postmark]]*

05-057-P02 *[[separate block: later label]]*

Poem to

Miss Lizzie Douglas

From Mollie

Woodbury, Tenn.

05-057-P03 *[[separate block: paper fragment]]*

Poems &

Essays.

Editorial note. One postmark is readable after rotation; the other impressions are incomplete.

Scan 058 05-058

Manuscript | Source 05, PDF page 58

05-058-P01 Song

05-058-P02 Just before the battle Mother

I am thinking most of you

While upon the field were watching

With the enemy in view

Comrades brave around are lying

Filled with thoughts of home and God

For well they know that on the morrow

Some may sleep beneath the sod

05-058-P03 Chorus Farewell Mother you may never

Press me to your heart again

But oh you will not forget me Mother

If I'm numbered with the slain

05-058-P04 Oh I long to see you Mother

And the loving ones at home

But I'll never leave our banner

Till in honor I can come

Tell those traitors all *[[deleted: illegible]]* *[[illegible]]*

That their cruel words we know

In every battle kill the soldier

By the help they give the foe

05-058-P05 Chorus Farewell &c.

Editorial note. The song is transcribed from this manuscript, preserving its wording. A cancellation and blot make the end of the “traitors” line uncertain.

Scan 059 05-059

Manuscript | Source 05, PDF page 59

05-059-P01 Hark! I hear the bugle sounding
Tis the signal for the fight
Now may God protect you Mother
As He ever does the right
Tis the battle cry of freedom
How it swells upon the ear
Oh yes we’ll rally around our standard
Or we’ll nobly perish there

05-059-P02 Chorus Farewell Mother &c

05-059-P03 Written by request Dec 9th /66 For Cousin George
Mollie

05-059-P04 *[[separate block: miscellaneous notes at foot of sheet]]*
[[illegible]] *[[1?]]* bottle *[[illegible]]*
[[illegible]] Handsome *[[illegible]]*
[[2?]] lbs of flour
25 Cts worth *[[illegible]]*
[[illegible]] *[[salted?]]*
[[illegible]] loaf
[[illegible]] *[[fork?]]*

05-059-P05 Light domestic *[[illegible]]*
[[illegible]] *[[wine?]]* *[[illegible]]* gloves
sugar & coffee *[[illegible]]* bottle

Editorial note. The song ends above a group of much less legible household or shopping notes. The latter are included separately rather than omitted.

Scan 060 05-060

Later label | Source 05, PDF page 60

05-060-P01 Concerning Uncle
George Douglas
– his work at
Sylvanna Church
– his death
Sept. 23, 1923

Scan 061 05-061

Manuscript | Source 05, PDF page 61

05-061-P01 was brought back and buried from the Church that had been his life work.

05-061-P02 He was a strong character and was *[[inserted: in full sense an excellent leader]]* While in his prime to direct the affairs of the Church, he was unable to train anyone to take his place and after his death the congregation was torn by dissensions and after a few years ceased to consistently meet

Editorial note. This fragment appears to continue scan page 62. The phrase about leadership is interlinear; its intended insertion point is not entirely clear.

Scan 062 05-062

Manuscript | Source 05, PDF page 62

05-062-P01 My father continued his labors with the Church at Sylvana until his death Sept 23 1923. Though opposing the Sunday School he did not withdraw from the congregation but endeavored to present the truth as he understood it. His health became impaired and he realized that his work was done. He died in Ga and

Editorial note. The closing “and” appears to continue into scan page 61, which precedes this page in the supplied PDF. The reference to “My father” does not by itself identify the writer.

Scan 063 05-063

Later label | Source 05, PDF page 63

05-063-P01 Poem “In Answer to the Author of ‘Georgie’”

Scan 064 05-064

Manuscript | Source 05, PDF page 64

05-064-P01 There in mist my vision failing
As bending o’er the iron railing
Vain regrets my soul assailing
Passed in review a life that little fruitage bore.
All its longing and its yearning
All its fruits to ashes turning
All its fever fiercely burning
Through my frenzied brain, the stormy passions tore

05-064-P02 The years to come all desolated
To the thorn and rockwaste fated
Dull despair to sorrow mated
Spread their pall upon the soul and bid hope *[[flee?]]* *[[door?]]*
Clouds above—the darkness falling
Night’s deep’ning gloom in mist appalling
Future years to conflict calling
Conflict with that Fate which life’s disasters bore

05-064-P03 Yesterday brought its roseate vision
 Today Fate holds us in derision
 Tomorrow in the fields elysian
 We'll dream again the dreams dreamed on life's
 Sunrise shore

Editorial note. Lineation follows the manuscript verse. Two words at the end of the fourth line of the second stanza are uncertain.

Scan 065 05-065

Manuscript | Source 05, PDF page 65

05-065-P01 Now that life is slowly sinking
 Light and shadow closely linking
 And the soul Nepenthe drinking
 Will resign its burdens on the dark Plutonian *[[inserted: shore]]*
 When death's shiv'ring chill comes o'er us
 Which our loved ones felt before us
 We may join the blissful Chorus
 Which swells the everlasting anthem
 Where saints their homage pour.

Scan 066 05-066

Manuscript | Source 05, PDF page 66

05-066-P01 In answer to the Author of "Georgie."

05-066-P02 I seek not for devoted dears.—
 "Platonic friendship at my years,"
 Most surely will suffice,
 Impassioned hours have long gone by—
 The furtive glance—the pensive sigh—
[[Was as for lovers nice?]].
 Give me a strong and helping hand
 While adverse clouds hang low,
 A friend in danger's hour, who'll stand
 Then onward will I go
 I'll meet cold fate, with heart elate
 And smile at fortune's frown,
 I'll bare my breast, to its rudest blast,
 Altho' I may go down,

05-066-P03 "Beauties newblown" will Nature bring
 With each returning vernal Spring
 And I enjoy these,
 The flowrets on the prairies wide
 The murmuring streams which sweetly glide
 The grand and lofty trees,

Altho' I am an Anchorite
 Absolved from humankind
 Some joys will stop with me o'er night
 And leave a pledge behind,
 That in after years, thro' changeful cares
 They'll call around once more
 And bring with them, some nameless gem
 "From the distant Aiden shore,

05-066-P04 Thus Hope is still the harbinger
 Of many a blissful coming year
 Which fortune may deny.

Editorial note. The sixth line remains a tentative reading. No substitute has been imported from another version of the poem. The closing quotation after "shore" is not visible.

Scan 067 05-067

Manuscript | Source 05, PDF page 67

05-067-P01 But still I'll seize the brighter side,
 The cheerful hours where pleasures glide
 Beneath a sunlit sky,
 Today, I'll take the sweets which come
 Tomorrow, then, likewise,
 And thus I will be sure of some
 From Fortune, as it flies
 But idle thought, with love o'erfraught
 I'm sure is a burlesque
 When sent to one, "whose work is done,"
 And's nothing now to risk.

Scan 068 05-068

Later label | Source 05, PDF page 68

05-068-P01 Poem & Song
 Ballad
 Jan. 22, 1881

Scan 069 05-069

Manuscript | Source 05, PDF page 69

05-069-P01 *[[separate block: docket]]*
 Song Ballad
 Jan the 22,
 1881.

05-069-P02 *[[separate block: verse]]*
 Swinging in the lane.

05-069-P03 Oh! how oft we've talked of childhood's joys
 Of tricks we joined to play
 Upon each other while at school
 To pass the time away
 Oh! the many long bright day's ago
 Will never come again
 That little Rosa Nell and I
 Went swinging in the lane.

05-069-P04 Cho
 But yet I'd give this world to be
 With Rosa Nell again
 I never never shall forget
 Swinging in the lane

05-069-P05 The boys and girls would often go
 Fishing in the Brook
 With spools of thread for fishing lines
 And bended pins for hooks

Editorial note. Sheet rotated for reading. Verse is on the right half; docket is on the left.

Scan 070 05-070

Manuscript | Source 05, PDF page 70

05-070-P01 They often wished me with them too
 But only wished in vain
 I'd rather be with Rosa Nell
 Swinging in the lane. (Cho)

05-070-P02 But then the cloud of sorrow came
 A strange young man from town
 Was introduced to Rosa Nell
 By Aunt Jemima Brown
 She stayed away from school one day
 The truth to me was plain
 She'd gone off with that city chap
 Swinging in the lane. (Cho)

05-070-P03 Now all young men with tender hearts
 Pray take advice from me
 Dont be so quick to fall in love
 With every girl you see
 For if you do you'll find it out
 You've only loved in vain
 They go off with some other chap
 Swinging in the lane. (Cho)

Editorial note. Rotated for reading; continues the song on scan page 69.

Scan 071 05-071

Manuscript | Source 05, PDF page 71

05-071-P01 *[[separate block: upper fragment]]*

And we should improve
 Those talents conceded
 And they will shine brightly
 From the hills of the *[[West?]]*

05-071-P02 And we should improve them

05-071-P03 *[[separate block: middle fragment]]*

We speak of the flowers
 That glow with ease
 And send the sweet odors
 On the soft gentle breeze

05-071-P04 We hear the sweet musick

Of the birds in the wood
 And we should be *[[illegible]]*

05-071-P05 *[[separate block: lower fragment]]*

and cast a ray *[[out?]]*

05-071-P06 For nature seems working

With its bright golden pen
 The hand of the *[[most high?]]*
 And make them a gain

Editorial note. Three separate paper fragments are arranged vertically. Several lines are faded. The spatial gaps and fragment boundaries are preserved by labels, without supplying missing verse.

Scan 072 05-072

Manuscript | Source 05, PDF page 72

05-072-P01 *[[separate block: upper fragment]]*

The beauties of nature
 As we now behold
 The great art *[[covered?]]*
 With flowers of gold

05-072-P02 *[[separate block: middle fragment]]*

With patience and with care
 And they will assist us
 In *[[decent?]]* and in fear

05-072-P03 But ah should we be reckless

In this bright glorious year
 And fail to improve
 Those talents with care

05-072-P04 *[[separate block: lower fragment]]*

Some of this broad *[[domain?]]*

Are rich and *[[wide?]]*

That our tallents were not improved

Though burdened with *[[wealthe?]]*

Editorial note. Three paper fragments; pale ink leaves several uncertain readings. “tallents” is retained.

Scan 073 05-073

Printed form with handwriting and later label | Source 05, PDF page 73

05-073-P01 *[[separate block: receipt]]*

Waxahachie, Texas, Oct *[[14?]]* 1874

A. TRIPPET & SON Bought of

[[blank]] Bales Cotton,

[[illegible]] lbs. at *[[6½?]]*

05-073-P02 Charges.

Weighing, 15

On account, *[[blank]]*

Rent, *[[blank]]*

Cash to balance, \$*[[26.75?]]*

05-073-P03 *[[separate block: later label]]*

Receipt of sale of cotton

bought by A Trippet &

Son from Geo. Douglas

Waxahachie, Texas

Oct. 14, 1874

Editorial note. The receipt is faded. Its date, rate and balance are less clear than the date on the later label; the label has not been substituted into the uncertain fields.

Scan 074 05-074

Later label | Source 05, PDF page 74

05-074-P01 Endorsement of the

Congregation

(for) Sylvana Church.

George Douglas

Sept 1888 -

Elders H. Douglas

H. G. Orr

Editorial note. Identifying slip also reproduced in source 03, scan page 2.

Scan 075 05-075

Manuscript | Source 05, PDF page 75

05-075-P01 *[[separate block: main endorsement]]*

This certifies that Bro. George Douglas, who is a member of the Church of Christ worshipping at Sylvana Ellis County Texas, has for some length of time been laboring in word and doctrine, and wishing him to continue in the work, we take pleasure in stating that he goes with our full permission & hearty approval. May he realize with the Apostle Paul. "Woe is me if I preach not the Gospel of Christ" - Ever remembering the Solemn Charge to Timothy to preach the Word &c -

05-075-P02 *[[separate block: docket]]*

Endorsement
of the
Sylvana Congregation

Editorial note. Main text and inverted docket share this scan. They are also reproduced separately in source 03, scan pages 3–4. Right-hand line ends are close to the scan boundary.

Scan 076 05-076

Manuscript | Source 05, PDF page 76

05-076-P01 Given by Order of the Church
On the 2nd Lords day in
Sept 1888

05-076-P02 Elders
H. Douglas
H G Orr

Editorial note. Also reproduced in source 03, scan page 5. A brace groups the names under “Elders”.

Scan 077 05-077

Later label | Source 05, PDF page 77

05-077-P01 Sermon notes
Sylvana Church
(Brushy Creek)
Feb 16, 1883
L(?) Douglas

Editorial note. Identifying slip also reproduced in source 02, scan page 2. The question mark is on the slip.

Scan 078 05-078

Manuscript | Source 05, PDF page 78

05-078-P01 *[[Of?]]* all the thoughts enclosed in the language of Inspiration *[[lost: left edge]]* its laws its precepts its promises what is there that conveys more, to our minds and hearts than is expressed in this short sentence? Jesus wept. Let us look a moment at the character of Jesus: who, and what is he? If we accept the truths of the Bible, he is the son of God, The King of the Jews, The bright and morning star! A

ruler of the Jews came to Jesus and said, "we know thou art a teacher come from God for no man can do the miracles that thou doest, except God be with him." Look then at the power of this man: by his word water is turned into wine. The blind receive their sight, the lame walk. By His word the tempest is stilled, and He walks the waves of the wild Galilee. By His word the dead are called back to life again. Truly He was the son of God.

05-078-P02 But it is not from the Bible alone that we have testimony in regard to the greatness of this man. Renan in his Life of Christ says "All ages will proclaim that among the sons of men there were none born greater than Jesus." His goodness, *[[greatness?]]*, his omnipotent power, we cannot doubt. We stand in awe as we contemplate them, and our hearts acknowledge him as King of Kings and Lord of Lords. But while we contemplate all of this glorious majesty our eye falls upon this simple sentence Jesus wept. What do we learn by this? by these two short words. We learn that He had a heart that could be touched by the sorrows and Suffering of our frail humanity: that Sympath~~[[lost: torn edge]]~~

Editorial note. Also reproduced in source 02, scan page 3. Damaged line beginnings and the torn final word remain unresolved. Continues on scan page 79.

Scan 079 05-079

Manuscript | Source 05, PDF page 79

05-079-P01 the power to "make e'en the wretched blessed" had its abode in His breast and that He could be touched by a feeling of our infirmities. How our hearts thrill with emotions of Love and thankfulness when we think of this blessed truth, that He was in sympathy with the sorrows of frail humanity.

05-079-P02 More than eighteen hundred years have been measured by the revolving Earth since Jesus walked the shores and waves of Galilee, but the influence of His words and life, are still felt. And down through the vista of the coming Ages they will be felt till time shall be no more. And with all the records of His wonderful life this simple truth will descend with the others, Jesus wept.

05-079-P03 L. Douglas.
Sylvana Feb 16th 1883

05-079-P04 Forever reign victorious King
Wide through the earth thy name be known;
And call our longing Souls to sing,
Sublimest anthems near thy throne.

Editorial note. Duplicate appearance of the sermon continuation in 02-004. Read against this scan; "simple truth" corrects the first reading of 02-004.

Scan 080 05-080

Label | Source 05, PDF page 80

05-080-P01 The Beauty of Culture
by Sarah Douglas

Scan 081 05-081

Manuscript | Source 05, PDF page 81

05-081-P01 The beauty of female culture.

There is nothing more important than the cultivation of our minds there is given to each of us a mind some superior to others but it matters not what degree of intellect we possess it is the common duty of all to improve it If we do not do this what will be the result? why it will be as a field that is not in cultivation and grows up in bryars and weeds.

05-081-P02 The greater mind we possess the more we are expected to accomplish. I think there is more in the cultivation of the mind than there is in the mind itself.

05-081-P03 We must also cultivate the heart kindness of feelings and gentleness of disposition.

05-081-P04 There is also a great importance attached to the cultivation of our manners for what makes a young lady appear to better advantage than gracefulness and politeness of manners all true politeness originates in kindness of heart for if we feel kindly towards anyone then it is no trouble to act kindly to them.

05-081-P05 Then let us all *[[deleted: illegible]]* earnestly strive to accomplish this so that we may make ourselves equal with those that now so far surpass us.

05-081-P06 Sarah E. Douglas
April *[[21?]]*.

Editorial note. Essay. Date is faint; no year is visible.

Scan 082 05-082

Manuscript | Source 05, PDF page 82

05-082-P01 *[[illegible: approximately 3 lines]]**[[illegible]]* there is *[[illegible]]*the cultivation of a *[[illegible]]*but I beg *[[leave?]]* to differ with them and

to say *[[illegible]]* is *[[deleted: illegible]]* little or something more than a mere *[[illegible]]* it has *[[illegible]]*

There is more wealth *[[illegible]]* in *[[illegible]]* than greater wealth *[[illegible]]* virtue and truth

It is said that *[[illegible]]* selfishness is the *[[illegible]]*

Friendship and love *[[illegible]]* these *[[illegible]]*

esteem and affection are the principal elements

[[illegible]] of the *[[illegible]]* affection *[[illegible]]*

[[illegible]] has *[[illegible]]* after *[[illegible]]*

[[illegible]] emotions *[[illegible]]*

for all these *[[illegible]]* a tear

Who has not felt the sweet feeling of Friendship

[[illegible]] To any of the *[[illegible]]*

[[illegible]] will *[[illegible]]*

[[illegible]] kindly *[[illegible]]*

[[illegible]]

Pure True Friendship never die

[[illegible]] about Friendship [[illegible]]

[[illegible]] Life's bitter [[illegible]]

[[deleted: illegible]] [[illegible]]

[[deleted: illegible]] [[illegible]]

Editorial note. Severely faded and stained writing, apparently prose and verse about friendship. Surviving line divisions are retained here to help locate the extensive unreadable passages. Several entire lines cannot be recovered from this scan. This page requires further reading from a better image or the original.

Scan 083 05-083

Label | Source 05, PDF page 83

05-083-P01 Composition

“Parting from Friends”

by Emma Bell

Scan 084 05-084

Manuscript | Source 05, PDF page 84

05-084-P01 Parting From Friends

O! how sad we feel when we part from our dear friends! This is the case when we part a short time only, and expect to meet again soon, but how much *[[inserted: illegible]]* sad it is to part with them when we know that we will meet them no more in this world! Who can discribe the feelings of them who stand around the death bed of a loved father or mother, brother or sister, and hear from their dying lips the last fond words of love they will ever be permitted to utter. And then how agonizing to follow their lifeless bodies, and see them placed in the cold, and silent grave. No one can imagine the feelings caused by such a trial *[[deleted: expept]]* *[[inserted: except]]* those who have experienced it. All should be prepared to die, for we know not how soon we may be called upon to leave this beautiful world, and all our dear friends and loved ones. We should ever be kind to our relatives and friends for we do not know how soon they may be taken away from us, and then it will be a sad parting, indeed if we have ever treated them with unkindness.

05-084-P02 *[[separate block: annotation below essay]]*

Very good

Editorial note. The correction above “sad” is not securely readable. “Very good” appears below the essay in a different-looking hand.

Scan 085 05-085

Manuscript | Source 05, PDF page 85

05-085-P01 Emma Bell's Composition

[[deleted: illegible]]

05-085-P02 *[[separate block: writing across lower panel]]*

Tis true parting is Very painful but it is necessary

To part on earth that we may meet where parting

is no more and where sickness *[[illegible]]* *[[ever?]]*
can *[[illegible]]*

Editorial note. Docket runs sideways. The final lines are faded; the sentence cannot be completed securely.

Scan 086 05-086

Label and envelope | Source 05, PDF page 86

05-086-P01 To Mrs. (Mary) Douglas &

Cynthia Orr – daughters

of Rebecca Goodloe

from

B. F. Lillard

Murfreesboro, Tenn.

Dec. 6, 1883

[Regarding decision of Circuit Court judge in suit of nephews & neices of Mrs. Alexander,
(Rebecca T. Wright)

Jacob Wright, brother of Rebecca Wright Goodloe.]

– Decree appealed by Mr. Lillard –

– Shows Jacob Wright & Wife were cousins –

Rebecca Alexander their daughter, being equal heir of the father & mother of Mary Wright.

05-086-P02 *[[separate block: envelope reverse]]*

[[postmark]] FERRIS, / DEC / 8 / 1883 / TEX. *[[/postmark]]*

Editorial note. The bracketed summary is written on the scanned label; it is not an editorial addition to this edition. Relationship statements in the label should be distinguished from the original letter.

Scan 087 05-087

Manuscript | Source 05, PDF page 87

05-087-P01 Murfreesboro Tenn

Dec. 6–1883.

Mrs. Douglas and Mrs. Orr.

Ferris, Texas.

Dear Friends:

I send you an advertisement of the land sale which explains itself. During the Term of the Court, Chancellor Burton was sick and died. While he was sick a Circuit Court Judge held his Court and decided the case as to who the land goes to, but seemed very much tangled in the case.

05-087-P02 He decided that 180 Acres of the land that descended to Mrs. Alexander from her father, Jacob Wright, goes to or is inherited by the nephews and nieces of Jacob Wright, and to the children of his deceased nephews and nieces, or their representatives, and as he had about forty nephews and nieces, seventeen of whom are living, and about twenty three dead would make about forty shares into which the estate would be divided. As to the McGlothlin tract of 230 Acres, descended to Mrs. Alexander from her mother, to use his language he said this tract “ascends” to the heirs of Mary Wright from her daughter, the said Rebecca, and the father and mother being cousins, that the heirs of the father and mother of Mary

Wright, related to her in equal degree, or representing those in equal degree, take equal moities of said tract of 235 Acres – if such heirs or those they represent

Editorial note. Continues on the following scan. The tract acreage appears as 230 and later 235 on this page; both readings are retained.

Scan 088 05-088

Manuscript | Source 05, PDF page 88

05-088-P01 do not stand in equal degree to the said Mary Wright then the heirs nearest in blood to the said Mary, or them representing those nearest in blood to her of the whole and half blood will take the whole of said 230 Acres in preference to those of more remote degree.” I appealed from the whole decree to the Supreme Court as also did the McGlothlin claimants of the 230 Acre tract. I am in no way discouraged by the decision of the Court, and feel satisfied that I am correct in my construction of the law that Mrs. Alexander’s first cousins, living at the time of her death, inherit her whole estate from her, and that it does not ascend to the heirs of the Father, or Mother. About the time the case will be finally ended in the Supreme Court, the land money will be ready for distribution.

Very Respectfully,

B. F. Lillard.

Per Ida.

05-088-P02 Criminal and Chancery Courts to day are both in session and I have no time to write.

B. F. Lillard

Editorial note. Continuation of 05-087. Final note and signature are in a different hand from the body, which is marked “Per Ida.”

Scan 089 05-089

Label | Source 05, PDF page 89

05-089-P01 To Mrs. Mary Douglas
copy of petition
of right of
attorney
(written by
B. F. Lillard
Murfreesboro, Tenn.
1883

Scan 090 05-090

Manuscript | Source 05, PDF page 90

05-090-P01 State of Texas

Ellis County

I Mrs Mary Douglas of said County and State do hereby nominate and appoint B. F. Lillard of Murfreesboro Tenn, my true and lawful Attorney for me and in my name to demand of any person in the possession of the same, the distributive share or interest in the real estate that descended to me from Mrs Rebecca T. Alexander, late of Rutherford County and State of Tennessee, now deceased, I do further

empower him to sue for and recover said real estate, and to file a bill for partition, or for sale for partition, giving and granting to said Attorney full power and authority to do and perform every act whatsoever, requisite and necessary to be done in and about the premises, as fully to all intents and purposes as I might or could, if personally present at the doing thereof, hereby ratifying and confirming all that my Attorney may lawfully do, or cause to be done by virtue hereof.

This *[[blank]]* day of *[[blank]]* 1883

Witnesses,

Editorial note. Unsigned power-of-attorney text. Day and month are unfilled; no witness names appear.

Scan 091 05-091

Label | Source 05, PDF page 91

05-091-P01 To Mr. George Douglas
from

M. M. Dill – Feb. 26, 1883

Murfreesboro, Tenn.

regarding suit for estate of Rebecca Alexander being handled by Lawyer Lillard.

mentions relatives:

Mrs. Nance, Mandy,

sister of Issac Wright,

Scan 092 05-092

Manuscript | Source 05, PDF page 92

05-092-P01 Murfreesboro Feby 26th 1883.

Mr Geo. Douglas

Ferris Texas –

Dear Sir – Mr Lillard our Attorney has shown me a letter from you in answer to two letters that I requested him to write to your Mother and Cousin Cynthia Orr, and in reply to your letter I have this to say. There is no other Attorney representing any of the heirs of Rebecca Alexander and there is no necessity for any other, I have conferred with Cousin Docia Bivins, she stated that she was going to leave her part, I have also conferred with Isaac N. Wright who joined me in employing Mr Lillard to investigate and take charge of the whole matter and we gave him to understand that he would represent all the heirs, I have had letters written to all from a distance, and he has recd a letter from Mrs Nance – which has been answered and we are looking for a Power of Attorney from her, as the whole matter has been explained to her, and she stated that she wanted her part – Isaac Wright recd a letter from his sister Mandy requesting him to act for her. We want all the parties

Editorial note. Continues on the following scan.

Scan 093 05-093

Manuscript | Source 05, PDF page 93

05-093-P01 to join as Complainants in the bill to save costs to the Estate. and we thought it just to give all a chance to unite in the bill – The costs and Attorney's fees will of course come out of the proceeds of the land and you need have no fears on that, and I assure you that Mr Lillard who is competent and has the

reputation of an honest lawyer. and whom I have-known from infancy will treat all parties justly – Mr Alexander has told several parties that he will not litigate the matter – that he would do what was right about it – Our Attorney is running the case as smoothly as possible so as to avoid litigation, but the bill has to be filed to sell the land for division of the proceeds, and to settle the rights of the parties,

05-093-P02 We will not at present take any steps against the 640 Acre Tract of land sold by Alexander & wife, for reasons which will hereafter be given to you in proper time – The River Tract & the Arkansas lands will no doubt be surrendered up – We want to get the bill in next Court and have ordered Mr Lillard to prepare it. I wish they would return to him the Powers of Attorney immediately – Your Cousin
M M Dill.

Editorial note. Continuation of 05-092.

Scan 094 05-094

Label | Source 05, PDF page 94

05-094-P01 To Mrs. Mary Douglas

from

B. F. Lillard

Murfreesboro, Tenn.

Dec. 30, 1882,

also Feb 11, 1883

Requesting power of attorney in division of inheritance from Mrs. Rebecca (Wright) Alexander) daughter of Jacob Wright

Scan 095 05-095

Manuscript | Source 05, PDF page 95

05-095-P01 Murfreesboro Tenn Dec. 30/82

Mrs Mary Douglas

[[~~deleted: Ennis~~]] [[*inserted: Ferris*]] Texas.

Dear Madame

I suppose that you have heard of the death of your Cousin Mrs Alexander daughter of your uncle Jacob Wright. She did not make a will and her real estate descends to her next of kin consisting of her first Cousins now living being 3 of the Goodloe family, three of the Dill, two of the Brasher and six of the Thompson Wright family as I have been informed by Messrs Wright & Dill, I have been employed by a good many of the heirs to represent them in the matter and at their request I write to you, as it is very desirable that I should be the Attorney for all the interested parties and I want authority to act for you, I have written to Mrs Orr Post Office [[~~deleted: Ennis~~]] [[*inserted: Ferris*]]. Please notify her of the fact. We desire [[*inserted: to*]] act as smoothly as possible, and when I am clothed with the proper authority I will make the demand for the possession of the real estate consisting of 680 Acres of land assessed at \$8500.00 but of course land generally brings double the assessment. [[*inserted: also for possession of the 640 Acre tract hereafter referred to*]] If possession is not given on demand an ejectment suit will become necessary. After possession a bill will have to be filed for partition or for sale for partition, There may-be more real estate besides the 680 Acre tract, probably 300 Acres in Ark.

Editorial note. Insertion near the lower right runs into the margin. Original address Ennis is corrected to Ferris; the explanation appears on 05-096.

Scan 096 05-096

Manuscript | Source 05, PDF page 96

05-096-P01 They sold a short time before her death 640 Acres of the land in this County, Please sign the Power of Attorney I send to you and return it immediately, you can have two persons to witness it, but you need not incur any expense to acknowledge before a clerk as it does not have to be registered. A letter from you would have been sufficient authorizing me to represent you but I prefer the paper to be signed that I send to you, Please answer at your earliest Convenience.

Very Respectfully

B. F. Lillard.

05-096-P02 Feby 11th 1883 – The above letter was mailed and directed to Ennis and after 28 days returned to me. I now learn that your Post Office is Ferris – Owing to the delay I hope that you will answer me immediately – The 640 Acres sold as above referred to was sold in order to convert the property as I have been informed for \$6400.00 rather a depreciated price on one two and three years credit, the two last payments not due,

05-096-P03 The conveyance is defective – I have made a thorough investigation and am satisfied that the sale can be declared by the Courts null and void and the land can be recovered.

B. F. L.

05-096-P04 *[[separate block: lower note]]*

Whatever the law gives you is right and if Mrs Alexander had not wanted the land to go to her kin she could have willed it otherwise So she left the law of the land as her will,

05-096-P05 *[[margin]]*

P. S. If you do not join the others as a Complainant you will necessarily be made a party defendant and under a decision of our Court you being an adult and seeking no relief will take nothing and your share will be lost to you – besides within a few years you would be barred by the Statute of Limitations

[[/margin]]

Editorial note. Continuation of 05-095, with a later dated addition and an inverted postscript across the top margin. The legal assertions are those of the letter writer.

Scan 097 05-097

Label | Source 05, PDF page 97

05-097-P01 To George Douglas
from

B. F. Lillard

Murfreesboro, Tenn.

March 22, 1883

Defends his character & requesting right of representation in suit for inheritance of Rebecca T. Alexander

Scan 098 05-098

Manuscript | Source 05, PDF page 98

05-098-P01 Murfreesboro Tenn. March 22nd 1883

Mr Geo. Douglas

Ferris Texas –

Dear Sir – Your letter of March 15th has been recd. I think that you have been under a misapprehension about several things – In the first place you certainly must think that after I recover these lands that I want to handle the money that may arise from the sale – In this you are mistaken I simply wanted to represent you in the litigation (I mean your Mother & Aunt) I never draw the funds of a party unless specially requested to do so – it is too much trouble to keep receipts &c, but then at the same time I want you to understand that I am thank God far ahead in this world's goods, and I don't know of a human being to whom I owe a cent, or whom I ever wronged, You do not understand the law in this State applicable to Attorneys – If an Attorney collects money and fails to pay it over his License *[[deleted: was]]* *[[inserted: is]]* taken from him, he is forever prohibited from practicing law, fined a thousand dollars, and imprisoned in jail 12 months, If you remember my first letter to *[[deleted: you]]* *[[inserted: the ladies]]* I stated that a letter instructing me to represent them was sufficient, but the Powers of Attorney that I sent was a more formal way and was preferable, and that I did not care about them acknowledging it *[[inserted: before a clerk]]* *[[deleted: illegible]]* your first suggested the acknowledgement, showing that

Editorial note. Continues on 05-099. Several small revisions are recorded. “your first” is retained as written.

Scan 099 05-099

Manuscript | Source 05, PDF page 99

05-099-P01 that all I desired was simply to do the *[[lawing?]]* and this was at the request of those whom I represent here, This litigation so far has I regret to say exhibited no small amount of bitterness of soul on the part of some persons, who are not even interested in it, except to try to injure me, and to aid Alexander – They have tried to get some of my clients who live at a distance to discharge me and employ Alexander's Lawyer *[[inserted: & so far have failed]]* – Now if they can succeed in getting all the parties who do not reside here on Alexander's side that are made defendants as I was compelled to place your Mother & Aunt at the time of filing the bills, and then buy out my resident clients of Course the bills would be dismissed – It looks like a blind man ought to see through this – And again Alexander I learn wants to buy the land (which at one time he said was willed to him and now abandoned on account of my persistent efforts against him and others who did not want “to disturb their Cousin Andy or make him mad as they expressed it) and now if, in the bill that I have filed to sell it *[[deleted: illegible]]* he succeeds in getting most all of the parties on his side, he thinks that he could control to some extent the division of the land into lots, and buy at his own price – Can't you see into this – These are stubborn facts and I have thoroughly posted you in the whole matter, You have the recommendation of Albert Jetton of me as an Attorney, the editorial of the Free Press that I sent to you, also the certificate of Judge Burton the Chancellor before whom the case will be tried, of John Woods Chairman of the County Court

Editorial note. Continuation of 05-098. This same page appears again, inverted and at smaller scale, in 05-101. The doubled “that” at the page boundary is in the scans. The word tentatively read “lawing” is unusual and needs further review.

Scan 100 05-100

Manuscript | Source 05, PDF page 100

05-100-P01 ever since the War, of Col. N. D. Robinson Clerk of the County Court showing my character and standing *[[inserted: at the Bar]]*, that I am *[[deleted: illegible]]* an honorable man &c, and have practiced law for twenty five years; Not only this but had it not been for me, your Mother and Aunt would

have slept on their rights, because the will idea had taken hold of everybody else, and you would not have had any case here to employ any lawyer about; and now in consideration of all these facts could any reasonable person with any gratitude, or sense of justice, accept of the recovery of the property brought about by these services, and then turn their back on me, stab my reputation as a Lawyer and a man of honor, and close a correspondence with me by merely saying “we thank you for the interest you have taken in the matter” and then send a Power of Attorney to some kinsmen to employ (not your friend as I have shown myself to be), but to employ his friend to represent you in Court – At the same time I have referred you to Judge Peter Turney of Winchester Tenn – for information of my standing at the Bar, who has known me ever since the year 1860 and then introduced himself to me by saying that all the old Lawyers said that in a real estate complicated case I had made the finest argument that had been made at that Term *[[inserted: of the Supreme Court]]*. – But there is one thing I know, and that is, that some persons here have wrote letters to you prejudicial to me, It has been suggested to me that you have been informed that I am intemperate – Back in the past I had prescribed for me

Editorial note. Continues on 05-102; 05-101 repeats the preceding sheet. Clerk’s initials are read N. D.; the first may warrant further comparison.

Scan 101 05-101

Manuscript | Source 05, PDF page 101

05-101-P01 that all I desired was simply to do the *[[lawing?]]* and this was at the request of those whom I represent here, This litigation so far has I regret to say exhibited no small amount of bitterness of soul on the part of some persons, who are not even interested in it, except to try to injure me, and to aid Alexander – They have tried to get some of my clients who live at a distance to discharge me and employ Alexander’s Lawyer *[[inserted: & so far have failed]]* – Now if they can succeed in getting all the parties who do not reside here on Alexander’s side that are made defendants as I was compelled to place your Mother & Aunt at the time of filing the bills, and then buy out my resident clients of Course the bills would be dismissed – It looks like a blind man ought to see through this – And again Alexander I learn wants to buy the land (which at one time he said was willed to him and now abandoned on account of my persistent efforts against him and others who did not want “to disturb their Cousin Andy or make him mad as they expressed it) and now if, in the bill that I have filed to sell it *[[deleted: illegible]]* he succeeds in getting most all of the parties on his side, he thinks that he could control to some extent the division of the land into lots, and buy at his own price – Can’t you see into this – These are stubborn facts and I have thoroughly posted you in the whole matter, You have the recommendation of Albert Jetton of me as an Attorney, the editorial of the Free Press that I sent to you, also the certificate of Judge Burton the Chancellor before whom the case will be tried, of John Woods Chairman of the County Court

Editorial note. Duplicate appearance of 05-099, inverted and reduced in size. The writing was inspected upright and corresponds to that page; see its notes for the uncertain word.

Scan 102 05-102

Manuscript | Source 05, PDF page 102

05-102-P01 whisky for neuralgic rheumatism, and like every body else who uses whisky of any temperament, I sometimes used too much, but I never did use it regularly – and now for a great while I have abandoned the prescription, and I do not use any intoxicating drinks, not even berry wine, or cider, as the whole citizens of this Town will testify, and if any man says that I ever neglected my professional

engagements on account of whisky he tells that which is absolutely untrue, I do use two cups of Coffee per day, I smoke tobacco and sometimes a little Mullein prescribed by a Methodist Preacher several years ago, but my respect for ladies is too great to allow me to chew tobacco, and this is the extent of my stimulants, Isaac N. Wright, Col. Brashears & Mr Dill & others who reside here are my clients – they have known me from infancy & ought to know what is best, One other party said that she would have nothing to do with it – her and her husband both told me the same, and the latter lately – the other resident party employed a Counsel who came and wanted to join me in the bills, but said he also represented a lot of second Cousins, I told him that his clients interests conflicted, that my bills denied second Cousins having any interests, and that I should comply with the rules of the Bar, that is, when parties originate a suit, and some in interest don't want to employ their Counsel in a partition, they are made defendants & I would do so in this case, as I did not want to practice Law for persons who did not desire me to – he said he had not investigated the rights of the parties – I replied “that I had” And now I do not desire to take a Lawyer on the cases with me and teach him the law and pay him for the privilege by a division of my fees.

Let me hear from you immediately and if you desire further inquiries I will cheerfully answer you – Very Respectfully B. F. Lillard

05-102-P02 *[[margin]]* caused from Army wounds *[[/margin]]*

Editorial note. Continues 05-100. Scan is inverted. Small annotation above the first line appears to explain the rheumatism.

Scan 103 05-103

Manuscript | Source 05, PDF page 103

05-103-P01 P. S. In addition to what I have said I will state that I have been informed by one of your true friends, that you have been written to, to turn your back on me and to employ a certain other Lawyer here – I will now proceed to give you the origin of that – Mr Alexander sent for the old Gentleman to meet him in Murfreesboro one day this week – he did so – they went to the Office of Mr Alexander's Lawyer, and the three held a long *[[deleted: Counsel]]* *[[inserted: Consultation]]*, the result of which was, that he went from that Law Office, and consulted with another Lawyer, and then he wrote his letter suggesting to you to employ that Lawyer – Against this Attorney I have not a word to say, nor will I be so uncharitable as to say aught against any brother Lawyer – but no Lawyer is infallible, and a Lawyer is as liable to be imposed *[[inserted: on]]* as any one else, when the case is stated to him from the opposite side, and that too by an old person whose prejudices can be worked upon – Why did not Mr. Alexander bring into the Consultation your Cousin Albert Jetton whose store is within 75-ft of that Law Office, It seems to me that you ought to be able to see through all this, My bills and work have won the battle unless trickery turns the tide, but I am determined to head off any such warfare, and if any party gives aid and comfort to the enemy to defeat their own rights they shall do so with their eyes open – If Captured by the enemy of this Lawsuit they shall be willing Captures – I further learned that Mr Alexander's Lawyer said that he could not

Editorial note. Postscript continues on 05-104. Scan is inverted.

Scan 104 05-104

Manuscript | Source 05, PDF page 104

05-104-P01 represent your Mother and Aunt,

“but he did not say that about one of my clients, Mrs. *[[N?]]* last week who resides in West Tenn, Her son, down there had been worked upon by some one defaming me, and recommending to him Alexander’s Lawyer, and he accepted, but I overtook the parties, and Alexander’s Lawyer has been discharged by them, and I have been retained, and her son writes to me that in a few days he will have sent to me a regular Power of Attorney, – just as soon as *[[inserted: he]]* can have it properly acknowledged. I have set out to defeat these parties & I intend to do it, by every thing that an honorable man can do, nor do I intend to permit unjust and wrongful impressions to go out against me, I have as many diplomas from as good Universities as this Country affords, my Law Diploma was signed 25 years ago by Judges Green & Caruthers of Cumberland University, the ablest Jurists Tennessee ever had, and I defy any living man to point to a single stain of dishonor on my character – You yourself ought to be able from what I have informed you to understand all these matters – I would suggest that you lay all of my letters before some good Lawyer of your County, and I know what advice he would give you – There is nothing in this letter intended to reflect on your conduct towards me, Everything is written with the kindest of feelings – because I appreciate fully what has acted on your mind –

Very Respectfully

B. F. Lillard

Editorial note. Continuation of 05-103. The client's abbreviated name is uncertain. Scan is inverted.**Scan 105 05-105**

Label and envelope | Source 05, PDF page 105

05-105-P01 *[[separate block: envelope]]*

From Lewis Jetton

Mrs Mary Douglas

or Cynthia Orr

Redoake

Texas

[[postmark]] *[[illegible]]* VILLE / FEB / 14 / TENN *[[/postmark]]*05-105-P02 *[[separate block: label]]*

To Mrs. Douglas & Cynthia Orr (sisters-in law of

From Lewis Jetton

Feb. 12, 1883

regarding inheritance from cousin Rebecca T. Alexander

Editorial note. Scan is inverted. The parenthesis on the label is left incomplete. The town at the start of the postmark is not securely legible.**Scan 106 05-106**

Label and envelope | Source 05, PDF page 106

05-106-P01 To Geo. Douglas

from

B. F. Lillard
 Murfreesboro, Tenn
 Feb. 26, 1883

In regard to court suit of heirs of Rebecca T. Alexander

05-106-P02 *[[separate block: envelope]]*

Lillard
 in regard to Court
 suit of heirs of
 Rebecca T. Alexander
 Mr Geo. Douglas
 Ferris
 Texas
 Ellis Co.

[[postmark]] [[illegible]] [[/postmark]]

Editorial note. Scan is inverted. The postmark is too degraded to read securely.

Scan 107 05-107

Manuscript | Source 05, PDF page 107

05-107-P01 Murfreesboro Tenn 2–26–83

Mr Geo Douglas
 Ferris Texas –

Dear Sir – Your favor of 17th Inst to hand, I enclose you the letter of M. M. Dill which explains most of the matters about which you made inquiry, I would be as free from bringing a suit against any one to defraud them of their just rights as any person who would decline to receive the rewards of such litigation, The 640 Acre Tract of land was conveyed by deed to D Travis for the Consideration of \$6400.00 to be paid in three equal payments Augst 1882, 83, 84 – It was not dated but that is obviated by the date of the acknowledgement before the Clerk July 15–1881, by A. M. Alexander – on the same day a Commission was issued by the Clerk to D. M. McKnight a Justice of the Peace and a half brother of A. M. Alexander to take the Privy Examination of Mrs Alexander which he certifies to the next day, This deed was registered Sept, 1882, and she died Nov, 11 1882,

05-107-P02 Now the legal point in the matter is that the Privy Examination of Rebecca Alexander is a Judicial act of the Justice, and he being of kin by affinity within that degree under our Statute *[[deleted: the]]* privy examination was null and void and the deed conveyed no title to Travis, Now whether there was

Editorial note. Continues on 05-108. Scan is inverted. Historical legal argument transcribed as the writer's claim.

Scan 108 05-108

Manuscript | Source 05, PDF page 108

05-108-P01 any agreement between Alexander & wife as to the reinvestment of the proceeds I am not as yet advised – If this deed had been properly executed the sale would have converted the land into personalty and it would be absolutely the husband's money,

05-108-P02 My remark in my letter was simply the conclusion of one of my clients as to the purpose of the Conversion – One of them related to me that he was at Mr A's house on one occasion when Mr A. argued the propriety of selling out and purchasing property in Town and appealed to him for approval and he did not seem to like his answer or rather seemed displeased at it, which was against Town property &c, As to fees and the costs we are not allowed as in your State to take Contingent fees, it would be champertous and a suit so taken by an Attorney would be dismissed, but of course Lawyers do not charge so high where there is no recovery – we look to amount involved &c, I can say this much that we will have no Controversy about the fees, and as Mr. Dill's letter indicates we may avoid litigation, and simply have partition bills, and if it becomes necessary to litigate about the 640 Acre Tract of land I will notify you of all the particulars and await your advice before using the ladies names as Complainants – The parties are very much scattered, and I desire to commence proceedings in time for next Court and hope you will answer me immediately,
Very Respectfully B. F. Lillard.

05-108-P03 *[[margin]]*

No one will object to demanding of Alexander to turn over to the heirs the land, and when I get the Powers of Attorney I will then be authorized to make the demand for Mrs Orr & Douglas together with the others,
[[/margin]]

Editorial note. Continuation of 05-107. Main text is inverted in the scan; the separate top note is in the opposite orientation.

Scan 109 05-109

Label and envelope | Source 05, PDF page 109

05-109-P01 *[[separate block: label]]*

To Mrs. Douglas & Cynthia Orr (sisters-in law of
From Lewis Jetton
Feb. 12, 1883
regarding inheritance from cousin Rebecca T. Alexander

05-109-P02 *[[separate block: envelope]]*

From Lewis Jetton
Mrs Mary Douglas
or Cynthia Orr
Redoake
Texas

[[postmark]] [[illegible]]VILLE / FEB / 14 / TENN [[/postmark]]

Editorial note. Another appearance of the label and envelope in 05-105, with their positions exchanged. Scan is inverted.

Scan 110 05-110

Manuscript | Source 05, PDF page 110

05-110-P01 Murfreesboro Feb 12th /83

Dear Aunt

I am & have been acquainted with B. F. Lillard all my life he ranks as a first Class Lawyer of the

Murfreesboro Bar and is a Gentleman reliable in Every respect and will promptly attend to any buisness
Intrusted to his Care and I take pleasure in recommending him to you
Your Nephew Albert Jetton

Editorial note. Letter of recommendation; scan runs sideways. “buisness” is retained.

Scan 111 05-111

Manuscript | Source 05, PDF page 111

05-111-P01 Feb 12th 1883

My Sisters *[[Cinty?]]* & Mary –

I learn by accident that Mr. Lilard is seeking Buisness that he is writing *[[deleted: illegible]]* to the
supposed heirs *[[deleted: illegible]]* of Rebecca Alexander I think he is too fast

05-111-P02 I learn from Dr. Dickson to day that Mr Alexander dont want any Suit that if there be no will he
will do any thing that is right in the premises. My *[[dictation?]]* is that I would not bring Suit now under
the Circumstances till the thing is fully developed then I would Chose my own atorny – the case is not yet
understood

Editorial note. Continues on 05-112. Scan is inverted. The first sister’s name and the word before “is that” are
uncertain.

Scan 112 05-112

Manuscript | Source 05, PDF page 112

05-112-P01 Mr Lilard is working for big fees – of course you ought to kno what is best *[[deleted:
illegible]]* for you to do in the case

05-112-P02 your friends here will inform you of any thing that should occur prejudicial to your rights

05-112-P03 I would not give power to no atorny till I was acquainted with him

L Jetton

The above you must keep in secrecy in the family

05-112-P04 there is no excitement about the affaire here as yet

05-112-P05 Two common men working on *[[illegible]]* at a *[[distance?]]*
other Lawyers to save the case from

Editorial note. Continuation of 05-111. Small writing at the foot is faint and incomplete; its relation to the main letter
is unclear. Spelling and double negative retained.

Scan 113 05-113

Manuscript | Source 05, PDF page 113

05-113-P01 I believe A. M. A will do right – he has always been a Cleaver Man

Editorial note. Brief additional statement following the Jetton letter. Scan is inverted. “Cleaver” is the apparent
spelling.

Scan 114 05-114

Label and envelope | Source 05, PDF page 114

05-114-P01 *[[separate block: envelope]]*

Mrs. Mary Douglas

Ferris

Texas,

Ellis Co.

[[margin]] If not delivered within 15-days return to B. F. Lillard Atty Murfreesboro Tenn – *[[/margin]]*

[[postmark]] *[[illegible]]* / 13 / TENN *[[/postmark]]*

05-114-P02 *[[separate block: label]]*

To Mrs. Mary Douglas

from Lawyer

B. F. Lillard

Murfreesboro, Tenn.

– written 15th – no year date

Editorial note. Scan is inverted. Most of the postmark is unreadable.

Scan 115 05-115

Manuscript | Source 05, PDF page 115

05-115-P01 P. S. J. N. Spence the soninlaw of Mrs Bivins informed me that Mr A. M. Alexander about two weeks ago said that if they found no will that he did not want any lawsuit and that he would give up the lands, It is reasonable to suppose that a will conveying such a large estate and disposing of it would not be hid way in a corner – None has as yet been found and you may rest assured that none will be produced,

05-115-P02 Now as to my opinion about the recovery of the 640 Acre Tract of land – I have fully investigated the question and I am fully satisfied that the deed can be declared null and void, but whether the parties will seek to do this is a subject for their own consideration, it is my duty as a Lawyer to point out the rights and it is the clients privilege to exercise it, Mr Alexander is rich outside of this – If he was needy and to take from him the benefits of this 640 Acre tract of land would leave him poor I think the moral question would enter and I am free to confess that I could not very zealously prosecute a suit to recover it – I do not think any such considerations apply – We do not know what induced her to join in the deed, but we do know that for years she had refused to sell it, we further are informed that she said that her Father on his death bed told her that he made no will, and asked her to promise the same and that she said that she had so promised and that she did not want Mr Alexander's kin to have her property – So the law of the land was her will – If she had desired it she could have determined it otherwise, I do not even suppose that she knew her personal estate would go to her husband, and the taking of her Privy Examina

Editorial note. Postscript appears before the main opening of this letter in the scan order. Continues mid-word on 05-116. The reported deathbed conversation is a secondhand account.

Scan 116 05-116

Manuscript | Source 05, PDF page 116

05-116-P01 tion by a kinsman that she executed the deed freely and voluntarily and without the constraint of her husband certainly is a circumstance to arouse suspicion to say the least of it, But all these matters are subjects for the heirs to think about, I have been informed that a few of the heirs say that they will have none of the property, but against some of these no Statute of Limitation runs as two of them have living husbands, besides Mr Dill thinks that there are certain business relations existing between them and Mr. A. and that after he and others proceed to the recovery or get everything proposed then they will come in – so as not to incur the displeasure of Mr. A, These facts I write to you confidentially as I desire you to be thoroughly posted as to everything going on here, So far as I am individually responsible as an Atty, I suppose Mr A. Jetton & Mr Dill satisfies you as to that, and then you agree that all ought to have the same Attorney. I will expect to get the Powers of Attorney – Of Course it would be better for the Powers of Attorney to be acknowledged before a Notary Public – but as I stated before any written authority will do to bring the suits or file the bills –

Very Respectfully

B. F. Lillard

Editorial note. Continues the word “Examination” split at the boundary from 05-115. The legal claims are attributed to the writer. Scan is inverted.

Scan 117 05-117

Label and manuscript | Source 05, PDF page 117

05-117-P01 *[[separate block: label]]*

To Mrs. Mary Douglas

from

A. Jetton

Murfreesboro

Feb. 14, 1883

Rec. Lawyer Lillard

05-117-P02 *[[separate block: note]]*

Murfreesboro Feb 14th /83

Aunt

I write that you *[[lost: torn edge]]* know that I do not advise a Suit but only recommend Mr Lillard as a Lawyer

Yours A Jetton

Editorial note. Scan is inverted. Left edge of the brief note is torn.

Scan 118 05-118

Label | Source 05, PDF page 118

05-118-P01 To Mrs. Susanna (Sue)

Bell

from Cousin

L. A. Jetton

(Lewis?)

Readyville, Tenn.

Feb. 20, 1870

(Tells of death of Polly Wright)

Editorial note. The parenthetical "Lewis?" is written on the scanned label. It is not a new identification by the transcriber.

Scan 119 05-119

Manuscript | Source 05, PDF page 119

05-119-P01 1870

[[11?]]

Readyville Tenn Feb 20th

Mrs Sue Bell

My very Dear Cousin

I seat myself this cold Sabath Morning to answer your kind and interesting letter which I received in due time I would have written before now but have been very Sick and am just getting able to get about again Dr. Briges who Attend me during my sickness Thinks My illness was brought on by cold which effected my whole nervous Sistim I never Suffered so much in my life and am still very feble

05-119-P02 The rest of the family are all very well and getting on finely This cold weather Aunt Clark has been with us several days but is going to leave to morrow

Editorial note. Continues on 05-120. Several nonstandard spellings retained. Small number near the upper left is uncertain.

Scan 120 05-120

Manuscript | Source 05, PDF page 120

05-120-P01 if the *[[inserted: weather]]* is not to bad It is Thought The Legislature will Adjurn by the 15th of march And this may be her last visit to us We are all very sorry to give her up as She has been with us so much She seems like one of the family We will be very lonesome when she is gone. Sallie Wieden is also spending a few days with us She tells us that She has had Three *[[Divorces?]]* but is as lively as a cricket And thinks She would like to marry again if She could get a chance The kin are all Tolerable well at This time Johns wife has another fine boy Three weeks old Johns health is good as usual. Old Aunt Polly Wright died about two weeks ago She died I suppose with old age I have not heard *[[Saboth?]]* any Thing in *[[Bras?]]* family lately I suppose they are all well or we would hear *[[illegible]]*

05-120-P02 *[[separate block: right column]]*

You want to know all about all of the girls who they married and how they are getting on Well Sarah married a drunken trifling fellow by the name of Tullison They have been married fifteen years and have eight living children They are living on a rented place not far from *[[Mam?]]* Bras Tullison drinks up nearly all he makes And his family have a very hard road to *[[weed?]]* Smith Married a man name Popley he does not drink but is so lazy he hardly makes a support for his family *[[Temith?]]* is very sickly She reminds of a bag of cotton with a string tied around it She has only two children Marier is the looking and the smartest one of the family She married *[[Darnum?]]* *[[Vaught?]]* he was killed shortly after we came here in a drunken spree Marier has four children Two boys large enough to work She is living at her fathers

Editorial note. Two columns, read left then right. Family names, several words, and the small final line of the left column are uncertain. "She has had Three" is clear but the following word needs confirmation. The death of Aunt Polly Wright is reported here as about two weeks before the letter date.

Scan 121 05-121

Manuscript | Source 05, PDF page 121

05-121-P01 *[[Shonce?]]* married a widower with several small children I donot remember his name but Think he makes a very good living for her Mary is still Single and likely to remain so Joseph is married and lives in the city *[[Marion?]]* I will Tell you what Mr Akers Says about his *[[Soninlaw?]]* he Says The devil owed him a grudge and has paid him off in Soninlaws The *[[Bam?]]* is the oldest looking woman you ever saw to her age Aunt Jane also looks very old and has bad health Well Cousin Sue I still get very low spirited some times My health is bad If if I only Could get well and be able to work I would be better satisfied Pap is always Complaining about his poverty and That he has a hard way to get along and he is afraid he will come to Starvation Oh you dont know how bad I feel Sometimes but enough of a painful Subject The children are not going to School Mary and I were tending The *[[Shawl?]]* *[[inserted: work]]* ever since Christmas until I got Sick I would be glad to earn my living if I could Stand to work Give my love to all and write soon tell Ellen to write to Mary Give my love to Cousin Ellen tell her to look for a letter someday
Ever your friend and Cousin L A Jetton

Editorial note. Continuation of the right column of 05-120. Several personal names and the work mentioned near the end are uncertain. Scan is inverted.

Scan 122 05-122

Label | Source 05, PDF page 122

05-122-P01 To George & Lizzie
Douglas
from
Jessie Douglas
Cross Creeks, Tex.
Aug. 30, 1869
Announces birth of
Earl Stuart Douglas

Editorial note. Scan is inverted.

Scan 123 05-123

Manuscript | Source 05, PDF page 123

05-123-P01 Cross Creek Travis Texas
August the 30th 1869

05-123-P02 George & Lizzie, your letters were duly and gladly rec, for I am ever anxious to hear from home, or Brushy and its vicinity — I've nothing very interesting to offer at present. The weather is extremely hot and dry in this section since the ((flood)) as I term it and in consequence a great deal of sickness below this Mostly Chills and fever

05-123-P03 I was riding, three days last week trying to rent Me a place nearer Austin But failed All occupied for another Year. and the people not all But a great many sick for the season

05-123-P04 I have become a little dissatisfyed with the Mountains Oweing to the roughness of the road and distance from Austin I was fully determined to move to Arkansas this fall. But I must Confess that the grief and tears of a good Old motherinlaw is a preventative, at least as long as She lives and possibly She may out live Me.

Editorial note. Letter continues on 05-124–125. Image rotated for reading.

Scan 124 05-124

Manuscript | Source 05, PDF page 124

05-124-P01 My grass was a total loss; corn $\frac{1}{2}$ rotten my Cotton I thought at first was not injured But time tells it, I think maybe one third of a crop now all considered has a tendency to get a man down in the mouth a little But continuing in the same strain of Eloquence

05-124-P02 *[[deleted: illegible]]* tell Tom and Laura that Dubly Beats Me, But I must say that on the second of August Earl Stewart Douglas made his appearance Weighing ten pounds he is growing finely and *[[Ma?]]* has been up two weeks doing her work. I think that is enough to raise a mans ambition above rotten Corn mark — ((what you say)) not knowing exactly where I will get to mail this I will close for the present.

05-124-P03 Sept the 15th I seat Myself to add a few more lines, all been sick a little, though all well at present But Earl and he is improving. I have been gathering Corn *[[deleted: for a]]* few days (not half done) Will make or have 300 hundred Bushels sound Corn to My Share 150 or 200 rotten and half rotten Corn which

Editorial note. Continuation of 05-123. The manuscript reads Stewart; the later identifying slip 05-122 reads Stuart. “300 hundred” is retained as written. Continues on 05-125.

Scan 125 05-125

Manuscript | Source 05, PDF page 125

05-125-P01 will do the hoggs a little good

05-125-P02 If nothing happens I will start to the City in the morning, will Mail this then in order that you will get it a day or two sooner

05-125-P03 I fear from the progress of my Cotton in the way of its opening I wont make more than 1 Bag. McCluer off of about Eight Acres has already picked Between 5 and 6 Thousand so you see that the Overflow Makes against Me. There is still a gooddeal of sickness in the Country. No news, only the people will Marry down in these parts. dont know how they are to live. But that is their business not mine.

05-125-P04 As I have worked hard to day I will Close for this time write soon

05-125-P05 Yours in haste
Jesse Douglas

05-125-P06 tell Sarah I am coming to see her this Winter or fall

Editorial note. Conclusion of 05-123–124.

Scan 126 05-126

Identifying slip | Source 05, PDF page 126

05-126-P01 To Daughter Sarah
(Sal)
from
Jesse Douglas
Alexander, Texas
June 15, 1884

Editorial note. Later identifying slip, distinct from the letter.

Scan 127 05-127

Manuscript | Source 05, PDF page 127

05-127-P01 Alexander Texas
Sunday Morning
June the 15th 84
Dear Daughter
All tolerable well
hope you the same

05-127-P02 Well Sarah, the Hon J C Roe has got 18 Subscribed scollars with promise of Better By sending where she could, Andrew Turnbow has returned from Washington *[[illegible]]* made round trip in 3 weeks to a day *[[Living?]]* at same place says he will send if he stays thare I think you might say 20 shure

Editorial note. The line through "from Washington" appears to be a fold in the reproduced sheet; cancellation is not certain. Continues on 05-128.

Scan 128 05-128

Manuscript | Source 05, PDF page 128

05-128-P01 may be more I cant tell Mr Roe is anxious you would come and commence the 7th July. Now if that is the Best you can do I shall look for you and *[[leave out?]]*

05-128-P02 There will be a Barbacue at Alexander also 1 at Carlton on ! the 4th

05-128-P03 Nothing more of importance

05-128-P04 write what day you will be at Alexander

05-128-P05 Yours affectionately
Jesse Douglas

Editorial note. Conclusion of 05-127. The phrase following "look for you" is uncertain.

Scan 129 05-129

Identifying slip | Source 05, PDF page 129

05-129-P01 To George Douglas
from

Jesse Douglas
 Cross Creek
 Travis Co.
 Nov. 28, 1869

Scan 130 05-130

Manuscript | Source 05, PDF page 130

05-130-P01 Cross Creek Travis CO. Texas
 November the 28th 1869

05-130-P02 George In answer to your last; and Brushy generally, you wrote for Me to appear personally Its a failure as you perceive

05-130-P03 It was My intention all the time to come to Ellis this fall on a visit But when I was ready I was sick. then *[[lost: torn edge]]* My recovery Nancy was taken with Bordering on Congestion. previous to *[[lost: torn edge]]* Eli had a spell of fever. Earl has *[[lost: torn edge]]*ough We are all up now

05-130-P04 *[[deleted: illegible]]* Well My *[[lost: torn edge]]*rop amounted to one Bale *[[lost: torn edge]]* 434 lbs which paid My debts *[[lost: torn edge]]* Left me one dollar, the sale and *[[lost: torn edge]]*ttlement previous to sickness — *[[lost: torn edge]]* medicine & Dr Bill since Leaves Me about thirty dollars Behind, that I will be able to settle with the sale of Pork this winter

05-130-P05 I've not put up My hoggs yet wanting them to get the Benefit of the mast as much as possible But I expect to pen this week.

Editorial note. Damaged left edge: missing letters and words are not reconstructed. Continues on 05-131.

Scan 131 05-131

Manuscript | Source 05, PDF page 131

05-131-P01 George

05-131-P02 It is out of the question Me to move during the Old Stewarts life time I think She would go crasy. She is old and frail in body and mind, yet She may live longer than younger ones. I am not Shure whether I will remain on this place next year or not. a couple of months will decide that. As I Cant Mo*[[lost: torn edge]]* from this Country I will Leave *[[lost: torn edge]]* to make your figures In regard the Old Farm

05-131-P03 The Overflow and sickness given Me *[[illegible: approximately 3 words]]* in the way of a living, and *[[lost: torn edge]]* a going to take some time to *[[lost: torn edge]]* a Start again, there is a prospect of My moving to McCluers *[[Neibors?]]* which will Cut Me Out of My present Stock of hoggs I could not move them as they would come run Back to the mountains Should I leave them here some person Else would eat them. A moving Stuff goes for nothing But a Buyer has to pay the biggest prices

Editorial note. Continuation of 05-130. Damage affects the right edge and a central line; the elderly Stewart appears to be the mother-in-law discussed in 05-123, an inference rather than a name supplied by this page.

Scan 132 05-132

Manuscript | Source 05, PDF page 132

05-132-P01 Well I have made an investment in the way of Land for Sarahs Benefit 320 Acres lying on Kickapoo Creek in Hood County the Title to be transfered about the 20th of this month *[[deleted: illegible]]* which is a good one, unless sold for taxes; If So the parties agree to redeme at their expense

05-132-P02 the above Costing Me My Noble Animal Billy Capshaw — doubt Mcdonalds *[[deleted: illegible]]* Selim Superior. Well that trade *[[necessitated?]]* more Sickness throwed *[[lost: torn edge]]* Me lower down. Now *[[lost: torn edge]]* is ride a mule, drive a mule *[[lost: torn edge]]* up hire mule or walk

05-132-P03 *[[lost: torn edge]]*e Land traded for is the Lower East half of 640 Survey known as G C Briscoes headright

05-132-P04 I have gone it rather Blind But be it So, the Survey is 6½ miles from the Brazos Ive nothing Else interesting at present

05-132-P05 So write Soon and often

Editorial note. Continuation of 05-131. Fragment of that preceding page is visible at the left edge; it is not a separate text.

Scan 133 05-133

Manuscript | Source 05, PDF page 133

05-133-P01 I Believe that I *[[inserted: am]]* due let*[[lost: torn edge]]* to all of you But I did not want to write while we were sick so this will suffice for all My respects to all the familys and the children —

05-133-P02 My Love to Sarah

05-133-P03 It is almost impossible for me *[[lost: torn edge]]* Come this winter as I would ha*[[lost: torn edge]]* hire some person to attend t*[[lost: torn edge]]* fattening hogs & and Borrow *[[lost: torn edge]]* money to travel on

05-133-P04 Your Brother As Ever
Jesse Douglas

05-133-P05 *[[separate block: lower left]]*

Eli weighs 52 lbs

I will direct this to Henry as he is most Central
you will direct to Drip Springs

05-133-P06 *[[separate block: lower right]]*

Earl is growing fine

Stands his weight

Can almost Sit alone

I expect to mail this in Austin if nothing happens as the Election is at hand

Editorial note. Conclusion of 05-130–132. The horizontal line through the hogs sentence appears to follow a fold; not encoded as a deletion.

Scan 134 05-134

Identifying slip | Source 05, PDF page 134

05-134-P01 Warrenty deed
 of heirs & heirs in
 law convey to
 Lizzie Douglas
 the estate of
 Mary Douglas
 Oct. 8 - 1886

Scan 135 05-135

Manuscript | Source 05, PDF page 135

05-135-P01 Thence N. 60 E 540 varas a stake from which an Elm bears N. 30. W 3 varas, another N. 30. E. 3 varas.

Thence N. 30. W. 574 a stake from which an ash bears S. 30. W. 2 varas another N. 10 W 3 varas.

Thence N 60. E. 268 var more or less to a stake in Ephraim Andrews W. line.

Thence S. ½°. E to a stake in the North line of the Said A. J. Porter Survey.

Thence S. 60°. W. 888 varas to the beginning,

Containing in all thirty acres more or less

05-135-P02 To have and hold the same with all the rights title and appurtenances thereunto belonging.

And we hereby warrant and defend the title to the Said land unto the Said Lizzie Douglas her heirs and assigns forever against all parties claiming the same or any part thereof in through or by us. This October the 8, A.D. 1886.

05-135-P03 George Douglas
 Warren Douglas
 Laura Robison
 Geo. Stanford, Ellen *[[obscured: blot]]* Stanford.
 R. C. Farrar. M. D. Farrar
 W. E. Bell. Johnnie Bell.
 H. Headrick Sarah G. Headrick.
[[Thomas J. Robison?]]
[[inserted: H Douglas]]

Editorial note. Continuation of the deed opening scanned on 05-136: the source page order is reversed. The added name H Douglas is near the Stanford signatures; placement does not establish its legal function. The bottom signature is very faint.

Scan 136 05-136

Manuscript | Source 05, PDF page 136

05-136-P01 The State of Texas }
 County of Ellis }

05-136-P02 Know all parties to whom these presents Shall come, that we, the undersigned citizens of the State aforesaid, and heirs at law to the Estate of Mary Douglas Deceased, of the County and State aforesaid, for and in consideration of Services rendered to the Said Mary Douglas during her last years of life by Lizzie Douglas of the State and County aforesaid Do release give and convey unto the said Lizzie Douglas, all of our right title claim and interest in and to the Real Estate of Mary Douglas Deceased being meted and bounded as follows; A certain tract or parcel of land being a part of a 1280 acre Survey patented in the name of A. J. Porter.

05-136-P03 Beginning at the South West corner of the Said A. J. Porter Survey a stake, for bearings See Original Patent.

Thence N. 30°. W. 87 varas a stake from which an Elm bears N. 22. E. 3½ varas. A hackberry bears S 22. W. 2 varas.

Thence N. 60°. E. 323, varas a stake from which an ash bears N. 48. W. 1 vara, An Elm bears N. 57. W. 7. varas.

Thence N 30°. W. 17 varas a stake from which an ash bears N 70 W. 7½ varas, another S 67. E. 5½ varas

Editorial note. Opening of the deed dated 8 October 1886; its continuation and signatures are scanned immediately before it on 05-135. Bearing numerals should be checked against the original instrument before cadastral use.

Scan 137 05-137

Legal form | Source 05, PDF page 137

05-137-P01 *[[separate block: exposed portion of underlying deed]]*

Containing in all *[[obscured: overlying sheet]]*

To have and hold the same with all the rights title and appurtenances thereunto belonging.

And we hereby warrant and defend the title to the Said land *[[obscured: overlying sheet]]*

05-137-P02 *[[separate block: acknowledgment]]*

The State of *[[deleted: Texas]]* *[[inserted: California]]*

County of Ventura

05-137-P03 BEFORE ME, James McKee a Notary Public, duly commissioned and sworn for the County of Ventura in the State of *[[deleted: Texas]]* *[[inserted: California]]*, on this day personally appeared Thomas J Robison and Laura Robison his wife both known to me *[[deleted: or proved to me on the oath of]]* to be the persons whose names are subscribed to the foregoing instrument, and acknowledged to me that they executed the same for the purposes and consideration therein expressed. And the said Laura Robison having been examined by me privily and apart from her husband, and having the same by me fully explained to her, she, the said Laura Robison acknowledged the same to be her act and deed, and declared that she had willingly signed the same for the purposes and consideration therein expressed, and that she did not wish to retract it.

05-137-P04 Given under my hand and seal of office, this 14th day of October A. D. 1893.

James McKee

Notary Public in and for the said County of Ventura State of California

My Commission Expires Aug 31st 1897.

Editorial note. Acknowledgment attached over the earlier deed. Its 1893 date is distinct from the 1886 date in the deed.

Scan 138 05-138

Envelope and identifying slip | Source 05, PDF page 138

05-138-P01 Return to Box 448

OKLAHOMA, Okla.,

If not delivered within 10 days.

For Record

Miss Lizzie Douglas

Ferris,

Texas

Ellis Co.

[[postmark]]OKLAHOMA

MAR

25

A

1893

OKLA. [[/postmark]]

[[postage]]UNITED STATES POSTAGE

LANDING OF COLUMBUS

2 [[/postage]]

05-138-P02 [[separate block: identifying slip]]

Warranty deed

of undersigned

heirs-in-law

Convey to

Lizzie Douglas

the estate of

Mary Douglas

July 5, 1892

Filed Jan. [[deleted: 24]] 4, 1894

Editorial note. Envelope and later identifying slip are oppositely oriented in the scan. Stamp wording is partly canceled.

Scan 139 05-139

Legal acknowledgments and docket | Source 05, PDF page 139

05-139-P01 [[deleted: State of California

County of Ventula

Before me

This day personally appeared T. J. Robison and acknowledged to me that he Signed the foregoing instrument for the purpose and Consideration therein Expressed. Given under my hand and official Seal This]]

05-139-P02 Oklahoma Territory

County of Oklahoma

Before me L. N. Wise a notary Public within and for the County and Territory aforesaid

This day personally appeared E L Winiford of said County and Territory whose name is signed to the foregoing instrument and acknowledged to me that he Signed Said instrument for the purpose and Consideration therein Expressed. Given under my hand and official Seal This 25th of March 1893

L. N. Wise

Notary Public

My com. expires Jan. 11th 1895.

05-139-P03 *[[separate block: recording docket]]*

WARRANTY DEED.

JOINT ACKNOWLEDGMENT.

McDaniel Et al

Deed

TO

Lizzie Douglas

Filed for record January 4, 1894

at 12:30 o'clock and *[[blank]]* minutes P. M.

J. R. Champion County Clerk.

By *[[Samual A. Smith?]]* Deputy.

Recorded January 4, 1894

in Ellis County,

Record of Deeds

Book 46, Page 358.

J. R. Champion Clerk.

By *[[Samual A. Smith?]]* Deputy.

GEO. D. BARNARD & CO., ST. LOUIS.

\$1.25

Editorial note. Upper acknowledgment canceled with diagonal strokes. Lower acknowledgment concerns E. L. Winiford. Clerk/deputy names and dates in the faint docket require source checking.

Scan 140 05-140

Legal form | Source 05, PDF page 140

05-140-P01 1787 WARRANTY DEED with Joint Acknowledgment.

For Sale by Geo. D. Barnard & Co., Prs., St. Louis. E. Class 1

05-140-P02 THE STATE OF TEXAS,

County of Ellis

KNOW ALL MEN BY THESE PRESENTS:

05-140-P03 That we The undersigned heirs at law of The estate of Mary Douglas Decd late of the County of Ellis and State aforesaid, for and in consideration of the sum of one DOLLARS to us in hand paid by Lizzie Douglas of Said State and County and The further Consideration of Many Services rendered to the Said Mary Douglas during her last years of life by The Said Lizzie Douglas we do by These presence release give and quit all our Claim and by These presence

05-140-P04 have Granted, Sold and Conveyed, and by these presents do Grant, Sell and Convey unto the said Lizzie Douglas of the County of Ellis and State of Texas, all that certain piece parcel or Tract of land The Same being situated in Ellis County Texas and about 12 Miles N E of The Town of Waxahachie and

a part of The A J Porter 1280 acre Survey and More particularly described and Designated (as follows) Beginning at The S W Corner of The Said A J Porter Survey of land a Stake, for bearings See Original Patten — Thence N 30 W 87 varas a Stake for Corner from which an Elm brs N 22 E 3½ varas and a hackberry brs S 22 W 2 varas Thence N 60 E 323 varas a Stake for Corner from which an ash brs N 48 W 1 vara and an Elm brs N 57 W 7 varas Thence N 30 W 17 varas a Stake for Corner from which an Ash brs N 70 W 7½ varas an Other ash brs S 67 E 5½ varas Thence N 60 E 540 varas a Stake for Corner from which an Elm brs N 30 W 3 varas another Elm brs N 30 E 3 varas Thence *[[deleted: Thence]]* N 30 W 574 varas a Stake

Editorial note. Deed continues on 05-141; acknowledgments on 05-142. Spelling and form language, including “one DOLLARS” and “presence,” retained.

Scan 141 05-141

Legal form | Source 05, PDF page 141

05-141-P01 for Corner from which an ash brs N 30 W 2 another ash brs N 10 W 3 varas Thence N 60 E 268 varas more or less to a Stake in Ephram Andrews W, Line Thence S ½ E to Stake in The S, line of The Said A J Porter Survey Thence S, 60, W — 888 varas to The beginning Containing in all Thirty acres of land More or less The Same

05-141-P02 TO HAVE AND TO HOLD the above described premises, together with all and singular the rights and appurtenances thereto in anywise belonging, unto the said Lizzie Douglas her heirs and assigns forever. And we do hereby bind our Selvs our heirs, executors and administrators, to Warrant and Forever Defend, all and singular the said premises, unto the said Lizzie Douglas against us our heirs or assigns or any other *[[illegible]]* person whomsoever lawfully claiming or to claim the same, or any part thereof. Through us

05-141-P03 WITNESS our hands at *[[blank]]*, this the 4th day of June A. D. 1891.
Signed and Delivered in Presence of *[[blank]]*

05-141-P04 Nancy Douglas

Earl Douglas

J A McDaniel

Emily J. Daniel

Ora J Duff. W. D. Duff

E L Winiford *[[lost: cropped signature edge]]*

Editorial note. Continuation of 05-140. The boundary description here says S line, while 05-135 says North line. The bottom signature is cut by the source scan boundary. The deed date is June 4, 1891; subsequent acknowledgments bear other dates.

Scan 142 05-142

Legal acknowledgments and certificate | Source 05, PDF page 142

05-142-P01 THE STATE OF TEXAS,
County of Ellis

BEFORE ME R. P. Mackay Notary Public in and for Ellis County, Texas, on this day personally appeared James McDaniel and wife Emily McDaniel and Davis Duff and wife Ora Duff who are well Known to me to be the persons whose names are subscribed to the foregoing Instrument, and

acknowledged to me that they executed the same for the purposes and consideration therein expressed. And the said Emily McDaniel and Ora Duff Wives of James McDaniel & Davis Duff having been examined by me privily and apart from their husband, and having the same by me fully explained to them They the Said Emily McDaniel & Ora Duff acknowledged such instrument to be their act and deed, and they declared they had willingly signed the same for the purposes and consideration therein expressed, and that they did not wish to retract it.

Given under my hand and seal of office, this fifth day of July, A. D. 1892.

R. P. Mackay Notary Public Ellis county Texas

[[deleted: W. D. Duff Ora J Duff]]

[[deleted: State of Texas Before me J S Watson]]

05-142-P02 [[separate block: second acknowledgmet]]

THE STATE OF TEXAS,

COUNTY OF Erath

BEFORE ME, J. S. Watson a Justice of the Peace and Ex officio Notary Public in and for Erath County, Texas, on this day personally appeared Mrs. Nancy Douglas and Earl Douglas Known to me to be the persons whose names are subscribed to the foregoing instrument, and acknowledged to me that They executed the same for the purposes and consideration therein expressed.

GIVEN under my hand and seal of office, this 4th day of June A. D. 1891

J. S. Watson

Justice of the Peace and Ex officio Notary Public Erath County Texas

[[obscured: overlying acknowledgmet]]

[[deleted: Exofficio Notary Public

Erath Co Texas]]

05-142-P03 [[separate block: recording certificate]]

THE STATE OF TEXAS,

County of [[Ellis?]]

I, [[J. R. Champion?]] Clerk of the County Court of said County, do hereby certify that the above instrument of writing, dated on the [[blank]] day of [[June 4?]] 1891, with its Certificate of Authentication, was filed for record in my office, this [[4?]] day of [[Jan.?]] A. D. 1894, at 12:30 o'clock P M., and duly recorded the [[4?]] day of [[January?]] A. D. 1894, at 3 o'clock P M., in the records of said County, in Vol. [[46?]] on Pages 358.

WITNESS my hand and the seal of the County Court of said County, at office in [[Waxahachie?]] the day and year last above written.

[[J. R. Champion?]]

Clerk County Court [[Ellis?]] County

By [[illegible]] Deputy.

Editorial note. Printed singular pronouns are amended to plural by hand. They are rendered in their amended reading. The recording certificate is unusually faint; uncertain entries remain bracketed. Separate sheets overlap.

Scan 143 05-143

Identifying slip | Source 05, PDF page 143

05-143-P01 H. D. Winniford

To etal

Lizzie Douglas
Deed
May 5, 1891

Editorial note. "etal" appears at the right of the first two lines.

Scan 144 05-144

Legal docket and certificate | Source 05, PDF page 144

05-144-P01 *[[separate block: handwritten docket]]*

H. D. Winniford etal
Deed
To
Lizzie Douglas

05-144-P02 Filed for Record May 5th 1891 at 10½ Oclock AM
E P Hawkins clerk
C C Ellis Co T
62 p 590 &c

05-144-P03 *[[separate block: recording certificate]]*

CERTIFICATE OF RECORD.

THE STATE OF TEXAS,
County of Ellis.

I, E P Hawkins, Clerk of the County Court in and for said County, do hereby certify that the foregoing instrument of writing was duly and correctly recorded in my office, on the 5th day of May, 1891, at 3 o'clock P m., in Deed Record Book 62 page 590 &c

In witness whereof I hereunto sign my name and affix the Seal of said Court, at office in Waxahachie, this, the day above written.

E P Hawkins
Clerk County Court, Ellis Co., Texas.
A. Lasswell Deputy.

Scan 145 05-145

Manuscript | Source 05, PDF page 145

05-145-P01 State of Texas
County of Ellis

05-145-P02 Know all men by these presents, that we E L. Winniford & wife, Millie Winniford of Oklahoma Territy, Haller Roper & wife Mary H Roper & H. D. Winniford of Navarro County, Texas, John McCrary & wife Alice E McCrary of Floyd County Texas, (as heirs at law to the estate of Lucy I Winniford deceased) late of Ellis county Texas, for & in consideration of the sum of One hundred & sixty \$160.00 Dollars to us in hand paid by Lizzie Douglas of Ellis county Texas, the receipt of which is hereby acknowledged, have this day bargained sold & conveyed & do by these presents bargain sell & convey unto the said Lizzie Douglas, of the county & State aforesaid all & singular, our right title claim & interest in & to the estate of the said Lucy I Winniford deceased the same being a tract or parcell of land containing sixteen (16) acres more or less, being an undivided one fifth (1/5) interest in & to an Eighty acre

Survey, a part of a 1280 acre survey patented in the name of A. J. Porter situated in Ellis county Texas, & accrued to the said Lucy I Winniford by deed from Mary Douglas jointly with us as heirs of Rebecca Winniford & more particularly described as follows — viz

05-145-P03 Beginning at the N W corner of the Porter 1280 survey a stake from which an Elm brs N. 37°. W 65/10 vars. Thence N. 60° E 1344 varas a stake from which an Elm 14 inch in dia brs N 61° E 95 varas Thence S. 30° E to middle of Cottonwood branch 1030 varas. Thence with said branch S 60° E 130 vars a stake from which a cedar brs S 20° E 18 varas an Elm 6 inch in dia brs S 67° W 20 varas Thence S 60° W 1369 varas a stake in W line of the said A J Porter survey, Thence N. 30° W 336 varas to the Beginning, containing in all Eighty acres of land more or less, Together with all & singular, the rights members hereditaments & appurtenances to the same belonging or in anywise incident or appertaining, To have & to hold

Editorial note. Continues on 05-146. Initial I in Lucy I is the apparent reading; the name is not expanded. Fractions in the land description are retained as written, including 65/10.

Scan 146 05-146

Manuscript | Source 05, PDF page 146

05-146-P01 *[[separate block: repeated portion of preceding scan]]*

[[lost: cropped top]] 18 varas an Elm 6 inch in dia brs S 67° W 20 varas Thence S 60° W 1369 varas a stake in W line of the said A J Porter survey, Thence N. 30° W 336 varas to the Beginning, containing in all Eighty acres of land more or less, Together with all & singular, the rights members hereditaments & appurtenances to the same belonging or in anywise incident or appertaining, To have & to hold

05-146-P02 all and singular, the said premises, unto the said Lizzie Douglas, her heirs & assigns forever. And we hereby bind ourselves, heirs, executors & administrators, to warrant and forever defend all & singular, the said premises, unto the said Lizzie Douglas her heirs & assigns against every person whomsoever lawfully claiming or to claim the same, or any part thereof Witness our hands this October the 13th A D 1890

[[H. D. Winniford?]]

Walter Roper

Mary Roper

Alice E *[[McCrory?]]*

[[illegible: signatures in shadow]]

05-146-P03 *[[separate block: partial acknowledgment]]*

[[lost: cropped beginning]]

to be the person whose name is subscribed to the foregoing instrument, and acknowledged to me that he executed the same for the purposes and consideration therein expressed.

Given under my hand and seal of office this *[[2nd?]]* day of *[[illegible]]* A. D. 1891.

A. O. Walker

Clerk County Court Navarro County, Tex.

05-146-P04 *[[separate block: partial acknowledgment]]*

THE STATE OF TEXAS,

County of Navarro

BEFORE ME, A. O. Walker Clerk of the County Court in and for Navarro County, Texas, on this day personally appeared Walter Roper and Mary Roper wife of Walter Roper Known to me to be the persons

whose names are subscribed to the foregoing instrument, and acknowledged to me that they executed the same for the purposes and consideration therein expressed. And the said Mary Roper wife of the said Walter Roper, having *[[illegible: remainder in shadow and cropped]]*

Editorial note. Continuation of 05-145 with an overlapping repeat at the top. Several signatures and acknowledgment text are in deep shadow. The acknowledgments are more fully visible on 05-147–149; they are transcribed from those scans rather than silently filling this image's gaps.

Scan 147 05-147

Legal acknowledgments | Source 05, PDF page 147

05-147-P01 *[[separate block: upper acknowledgment fragment]]*

[[lost: cropped beginning]]

to be the person whose name is subscribed to the foregoing instrument, and acknowledged to me that he executed the same for the purposes and consideration therein expressed.

Given under my hand and seal of office this 2nd day of Jany A. D. 1891.

A. O. Walker

Clerk County Court Navarro County, Tex.

05-147-P02 *[[separate block: Roper acknowledgment]]*

THE STATE OF TEXAS,

County of Navarro

BEFORE ME, A. O. Walker Clerk of the County Court in and for Navarro County, Texas, on this day personally appeared Walter Roper and Mary Roper wife of Walter Roper Known to me to be the persons whose names are subscribed to the foregoing instrument, and acknowledged to me that they executed the same for the purposes and consideration therein expressed. And the said Mary Roper wife of the said Walter Roper, having been examined by me privily and apart from her husband, and having the same by me fully explained to her, she, the said Mary Roper acknowledged such instrument to be her act and deed and she declared that she had willingly signed the same for the purposes and consideration therein expressed, and that she did not wish to retract it.

Given under my hand and seal of office, this 2nd day of Jany A. D. 1891

A. O. Walker

Clerk County Court Navarro Co., Texas.

05-147-P03 *[[separate block: McCrary acknowledgment]]*

THE STATE OF TEXAS,

County of Floyd

BEFORE ME A D White J. P. & Ex-officio N. P. in and for Floyd County, Texas, on this day personally appeared Alice E. McCrary wife of John McCrary Known to me to be the person whose name is subscribed to the foregoing instrument, and having been examined by me, privily and apart from her husband, and having the same fully explained to her, she, the said Alice E. McCrary acknowledged such instrument to be her act and deed, and declared that she had willingly signed the same for the purposes and consideration therein expressed, and that she did not wish to retract it.

GIVEN under my hand and seal of office, this 4 day of March A. D. 1891

A D White J. P. & Ex-officio N. P. Floyd County Tex

05-147-P04 *[[separate block: exposed underlying acknowledgment]]*

[[obsured: overlying sheet]] of the Said E L Winniford having been Examined by me privily and apart

from her husband and having the Same by Me fully explained to her, She the Said Milly Winniford acknowledged such instrument to me to be her act and deed and She declared that she had *[[deleted: illegible]]* willingly Signed the Same for the purpose and Consideration therein Expressed *[[lost: cropped bottom]]*

Editorial note. Several attached acknowledgments overlap. The last fragment is the lower part of 05-149. The first fragment does not reveal the acknowledging party in this scan.

Scan 148 05-148

Legal acknowledgments | Source 05, PDF page 148

05-148-P01 THE STATE OF TEXAS,

County of Floyd

BEFORE ME A D White J. P. & Ex-officio N. P. in and for Floyd County, Texas, on this day personally appeared John McCrary Known to me to be the person whose name is subscribed to the foregoing instrument, and acknowledged to me that he executed the same for the purposes and consideration therein expressed.

GIVEN under my hand and seal of office, this 4 day of March A. D. 1891

A D White J. P. & Ex-officio N. P. Floyd County Tex

05-148-P02 *[[separate block: second acknowledgment]]*

THE STATE OF TEXAS,

County of Floyd

BEFORE ME A D White J. P. & Ex-officio N. P. in and for Floyd County, Texas, on this day personally appeared Alice E. McCrary wife of John McCrary Known to me to be the person whose name is subscribed to the foregoing instrument, and having been examined by me, privily and apart from her husband, and having the same fully explained to her, she, the said Alice E. McCrary acknowledged such instrument to be her act and deed, and declared that she had willingly signed the same for the purposes and consideration therein expressed, and that she did not wish to retract it.

GIVEN under my hand and seal of office, this 4 day of March A. D. 1891

A D White J. P. & Ex-officio N. P. Floyd County Tex

05-148-P03 *[[separate block: exposed underlying acknowledgment]]*

[[obscured: overlying sheet]] of the Said E L Winniford having been Examined by me privily and apart from her husband and having the Same by Me fully explained to her, She the Said Milly Winniford acknowledged such instrument to me to be her act and deed and She declared that she had *[[deleted: illegible]]* willingly Signed the Same for the purpose and Consideration therein Expressed and that She did not wish to retract it

Given under my hand *[[illegible: shadow]]*

Day of April A D 1891 *[[lost: cropped bottom]]*

Editorial note. The Alice E. McCrary acknowledgment repeats 05-147. Underlying handwritten text is shown without the overlying sheets on 05-149.

Scan 149 05-149

Manuscript | Source 05, PDF page 149

05-149-P01 Oklahoma Territory }

Oklahoma County } ss

05-149-P02 Before me *[[Raept Sudris?]]* a notary Public for Said Territory and County on this day personally appeared E L. Winniford & Millie Winniford wife of E L Winniford Known to me to be the Persons whose names are Subscribed to the foregoing Instrument and acknowledged to me that they Executed the Same for the purpose and Consideration therein Expressed and the Said Millie Winniford wife of the Said E L Winniford having been Examined by me privily and apart from her husband and having the Same by Me fully explained to her, She the Said Milly Winniford acknowledged such instrument to me to be her act and deed and She declared that she had *[[deleted: illegible]]* willingly Signed the Same for the purpose and Consideration therein Expressed and that She did not wish to retract it

05-149-P03 Given under my hand and Seal this Fourth Day of April A D 1891

[[Raept Sudris?]]

Notary Public

Commission Expires

[[1-1-91?]]

Editorial note. Notary's name and commission-expiration notation remain uncertain. Millie and Milly are retained as they appear. The expiration notation should not be reconciled silently with the acknowledgment date.

Scan 150 05-150

Identifying slip | Source 05, PDF page 150

05-150-P01 Inventory of Estate
of N L Douglas
given by Mary
Douglas..
Oct 3, 1874

Editorial note. Later slip appears to read October 3; the oath on 05-151 reads October 5.

Scan 151 05-151

Manuscript | Source 05, PDF page 151

05-151-P01 Inventory of the Estate of N. L. Douglas deceased as given by Mary Douglas relict of deceased

05-151-P02 640 acres of land a part of the A. J. Porter 1280 acre Survey located on Subletts creek Ellis co Texas, and patented in the name of the *[[deleted: same]]* said A. J. Porter.

94 acres of said land in cultivation worth \$15.00 pr acre | \$1410.00

546 acres unimproved worth \$5.00 per acre | 2730.00

9 head of horses worth | 265.00

20 head of cattle worth | 120.00

14 head of hogs worth | *[[73.00?]]*

20 Bee Hives worth | 40.00

2 pr Trace chains worth | 1.80

1 Plow worth | 4.00

1 Log chain worth | .80

1 Grubbing hoe worth | .75

Part Set waggon Irons worth | 4.00
1 grind stone worth | 3.00

05-151-P03 Subscribed and Sworn to Before Me October 5th AD 1874

Wm Hancock J. P. E C

Texas Precinct No 3

05-151-P04 Appraisers

E. A. Norman

W R Duff

Editorial note. Amounts are transcribed individually, without editorial recalculation. The hog value may read 73 or 43. "Relict" identifies Mary as the widow. No father of N. L. Douglas is named here.

Scan 152 05-152

Identifying slip | Source 05, PDF page 152

05-152-P01 Heirs of Mary

Douglas deceased

to (Deed)

Lizzie

May 28, 1896

Scan 153 05-153

Manuscript | Source 05, PDF page 153

05-153-P01 Inventory of the Estate of N. L. Douglas dec'd.

05-153-P02 *[[deleted: illegible]]* 640 acres of land, a part of the A. J. Porter 1280 acre survey, situated on Subletts creek Ellis co Tex and pattedented to the Said A. J. Porter on the 18th day of June 1849.

94 acres of the Same improved, worth fifteen dollars per acre | \$14.10.00

546 acres unimproved worth five dollars per acre | " 27.30.00

9 head of horses | " 2.65.00

20 head of cattle | " 120.00

[[deleted: 13]] [[inserted: 14]] head of hogs | " *[[73.00?]]*

1 Log chain | .80

1 Plow | 4.00

2 Sets trace chains | 1.80

1 Grubbing hoe | .75

20 Beehives | 40.00

Part Set Wagon irons | 4.00

1 Grind Stone | 3.00

Editorial note. A second estate inventory, related to 05-151 but not an identical copy. Periods separating groups of digits are retained. The value of the hogs is difficult to distinguish between 73 and 43. The land patent date is given here as 18 June 1849.

Scan 154 05-154

Legal acknowledgments | Source 05, PDF page 154

05-154-P01 State of Texas

County of Ellis

05-154-P02 Before the undersigned Authority, this day personally came George Douglas, Known to me to be the person who signed the foregoing deed, & to me acknowledged that he had signed the same for the purposes & consideration therein contained

Witness my Official seal and signature thereto this 9th day of October AD 1886

R. P. Mackay Notary Public

Ellis County Texas

05-154-P03 *[[separate block: second acknowledgment]]*

The State of Texas

County of Johnson

05-154-P04 Before the undersigned authority this day personally Came Warren Douglas Known to be the person who signed the foregoing Deed & to me acknowledged that he had signed the same for the purposes & consideration therein Expressed

Witness my official seal & signature hereunto this the 27th day of Jany 1887

Jno. T. Odom

Clerk Dist Court Johnson Co Texas

By *[[Jerry Towers?]]*

Deputy

Editorial note. Acknowledgments for the 1886 deed transcribed at 05-135–136. Deputy's name remains uncertain.

Scan 155 05-155

Legal acknowledgment and recording certificate | Source 05, PDF page 155

05-155-P01 State of Texas

County of Ellis

05-155-P02 Before me S. B. Farrar a Notary Public in Ellis County Tex on This day personally appeared H Douglas & Geo Stanford and wife Ellen Stanford & R C Farrar & wife M D Farrar & W E Bell & wife Jonnie Bell & H Headrick and wife S G Headrick all persons Known to me to be the persons whose names are Subscribed to the foregoing instrument and acknowledged to me that they signed said instrument for the purposes and consideration therein Expressed and the said Ellen Stanford wife of Geo Stanford and M D Farrar wife of R C Farrar & Jonnie Bell wife of W E Bell and S G Headrick wife of H Headrick all after being examined by me privily and apart from their Husbands and having the foregoing instrument fully explained to them they acknowledged to me that they signed said instrument of their own free will and for the purpose and consideration therein expressed and that they did not wish to retract it Given under my hand and official Seal This the 15th day of April AD 1891

S. B. Farrar a Notary Public in E, C, T,

05-155-P03 *[[separate block: recording certificate]]*

CERTIFICATE OF RECORD.

THE STATE OF TEXAS;

County of Ellis.

I. T. F. THOMPSON, Clerk of the County Court in and for said County, do hereby certify that the foregoing instrument of writing was duly and correctly recorded in my office, on the 29 day of May, 1896 at 9:40 o'clock A m., in Deed Record Book 92 Page 576

In witness whereof I hereunto sign my name and affix the Seal of said Court, at office in Waxahachie, this, the day above written.

T F Thompson

Clerk County Court, Ellis Co., Texas.

[[Jennie L. Clink?]] Deputy.

05-155-P04 [[separate block: docket]]

Heirs of Mary Douglas decd

Deed

to

Lizzie Douglas

FILED FOR RECORD

this 28 day of May 1896

at 11:30 o'clock A M.

T F Thompson

Clerk County Court, Ellis Co. Texas

By [[A. Lasswell?]] Deputy.

92 p 576

1.00

.15

Editorial note. The acknowledgment is dated April 15, 1891; filing and recording dates are May 28 and 29, 1896. These dates are not harmonized. The later identifying slip 05-152 belongs with this recording docket, despite intervening inventory pages.

Scan 156 05-156

Identifying slip | Source 05, PDF page 156

05-156-P01 Deed of land of

Mrs N L. Douglas (Mary)

to Lizzie Douglas

by Mary Douglas

Feb, 25, 1875

Scan 157 05-157

Legal acknowledgment and docket | Source 05, PDF page 157

05-157-P01 I hereunto affix my name, and acknowledge this deed before the proper officer This Feb 25 A. D. 1875

Mary Douglas

05-157-P02 The State of Texas }

County of Ellis }

Before Me the undersigned authority This day Personally appeared Mrs Mary Douglas who is to Me well

known and acknowledged to Me that She Signed the foregoing deed for all the Purposes and Considerations therein Set forth and desires not to retract it
To certify which I hereunto Set My hand and official Seal of office in Palmer the 25th day of February AD 1875 Wm Hancock J P E C
Texas Precinct No. 3
No. 86

05-157-P03 *[[separate block: docket]]*

3rd

Mary Douglas

Deed

To

Lizzie Douglas

Filed for Record

10½ oclock AM

Aug 21st 1875

J M Philips

Cl D C

Book O Page 3

75 — Paid

05-157-P04 *[[separate block: recording certificate]]*

The State of Texas.

COUNTY OF ELLIS.

I, J. M. PHILLIPS, Clerk of the District Court in and for said County, do hereby certify that the foregoing instrument in writing was filed in my office for record at 10½ o'clock a.m. Augst the 21st, A. D. 1875, and by me, on this the 21st day of Augst A. D. 1875, at 10 o'clock a.m., duly recorded in Deed Record O of said County, on pages 344.

To certify which, witness my official seal and signature, at office in Waxahachie, on this the day and date last above written.

J. M. Phillips

Clerk District Court Ellis County Texas.

Per H. E. *[[Mills?]]* Deputy.

Editorial note. Conclusion of the deed whose opening is scanned next, at 05-158. Docket and printed certificate give differing page references and times; both are retained as read. Deputy signature is uncertain.

Scan 158 05-158

Manuscript | Source 05, PDF page 158

05-158-P01 State of Texas

[[County of Ellis?]]

05-158-P02 Know all parties to whom these presents shall come that I Mary Douglas of the county and State aforesaid, for and in consideration of the quit claim deed of Lizzie Douglas, in and to the estate of N L Douglas, unto me made, and the receipt of which is hereby acknowledged, do bargain release and convey unto the said Lizzie Douglas all of the following described Tract or parcel of land to wit; situated in Ellis county Texas about 10 miles N. E. from the town of Waxahachie on Subletts creek and being a

part of a survey patented in the name of A. J. Porter. Beginning at a stake from which an Elm 15 in. dia
 brs *[[N. 33. E. ?]]* 23 vs. another 6 in dia brs N. 62. W. 68 vs.

05-158-P03 Thence N. 30° W. at 138 vs Subletts creek, at 975 vs. a stake in S. line of an 80 acre survey
 made to the heirs of Rebecca Winniford.

Thence S. 60° W. 475 vs. a Stake from which an Elm 4 in brs S. 15. W. 7 vs. another brs S. 57. W. 7 vs.

Thence S. 30° E. 975 vs. a Stake from which an Elm 4 in. brs N. 11° E. 14 vs.

Thence N. 60° E 475 vs. to the beginning containing 82 acres more or less, To have and hold the same
 together with all and singular, the rights title privileges and appurtenances thereunto belonging forever,
 and hereby bind myself, my heirs and assigns to forever warrant and defend the title to the same unto the
 said Lizzie Douglas, her heirs and assigns forever, against all parties claiming the same or any part thereof
 in through or by me. Provided however that I am to retain the use and control of the described land and its
 tenements during the period of my natural life. In Witness whereof

Editorial note. Deed opening; conclusion and Mary Douglas signature are on 05-157. Faded heading and initial
 boundary bearing are tentative. Historical land-description language is transcribed, not interpreted as current title
 evidence.